Med Interview markschemes

577 individually authored question markschemes

Practice guidance, not official admissions criteria. Mark the general skill or reasoning. Details in brackets are illustrative examples, not facts or phrases that must be repeated: credit other accurate examples and equivalent valid reasoning. Start, Middle and End are suggested structures, not a required script. Mistakes are pitfalls, not positive checklist points. Visual datasets are fictional. Current legal, policy and clinical details should be checked against relevant official guidance.

What has influenced your decision to pursue a career in medicine?

General

- Genuine and personal motivation
- Realistic understanding of medicine
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally, without reciting the framework
- Reflects on experiences rather than simply listing them

Start

- Directly answers what influenced them
- Introduces a meaningful personal experience or reason
- Avoids a generic opening

Middle

- Uses one or two meaningful experiences
- Explains what they learnt from each experience
- Links the learning specifically to medicine
- Shows awareness of both rewarding and challenging aspects of medicine

End

- Explains how these experiences strengthened their motivation
- Shows realistic commitment to medicine
- Ends with reflection rather than repeating earlier points

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing experiences without reflection
- Giving reasons that could apply to any career
- Idealising medicine
- Focusing mainly on money, status or prestige

Why are you choosing medicine rather than nursing, pharmacy, dentistry or another healthcare profession?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the doctor's particular combination of responsibilities

Middle

- Compares diagnosis and management with other professions respectfully
- Explains why those responsibilities fit their interests

End

- Justifies personal fit without ranking professions

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling nursing or pharmacy less skilled or less caring

In what ways have you explored whether medicine is genuinely the right career for you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how they tested their initial interest in medicine

Middle

- Uses exploration such as conversations, reading or observation
- Describes evidence that challenged as well as confirmed expectations

End

- Identifies an uncertainty they still want to explore

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating attendance at a placement as proof of suitability

Which experiences have helped prepare you for studying medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Chooses experiences relevant to readiness for medical study

Middle

- Explains a developed skill and how it was practised
- Connects learning with independent study or interacting with people

End

- Identifies a remaining preparation need

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing achievements without explaining preparation

What lessons did you take from your work experience or clinical exposure?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Identifies one concrete lesson from clinical exposure

Middle

- Separates what they observed from what they personally did
- Reflects on communication, teamwork or patients' needs

End

- Explains how the lesson will change their behaviour

Mistakes to avoid

- Disclosing identifiable patient details or exaggerating their role

If you have taken a gap year, how have you used that time and what has it taught you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Briefly explains how their gap year was used if applicable

Middle

- Connects activities with growth rather than prestige
- Reflects honestly on setbacks or changed plans

End

- Explains readiness to return to study

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming a gap year must include expensive travel or clinical work

If you did not receive a medical school offer this year, what would your next step be?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges disappointment and describes a realistic next step

Middle

- Seeks feedback on the application
- Weighs reapplication against other considered options

End

- Sets a practical improvement plan with review points

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming an offer is owed or proposing identical reapplication without reflection

Where do you hope to be professionally in around ten years?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Offers a plausible direction for their professional development

Middle

- Recognises training and interests may change
- Includes patient care, teamwork and continued learning

End

- Keeps ambitions flexible rather than guaranteeing a specialty

Mistakes to avoid

- Inventing a fixed promotion timetable

Are there any areas of medicine that particularly interest you at the moment? Why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names an area of medicine and the reason for interest

Middle

- Supports interest with a specific exploration or observation
- Discusses what remains unknown about its everyday work

End

- Shows openness to discovering other fields

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing a specialty solely for status or claiming settled expertise

What would you most like to achieve during your career as a doctor?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- States a meaningful contribution they hope to make as a doctor

Middle

- Explains who would benefit and how
- Balances ambition with achievable development

End

- Links achievement to patients or service improvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating achievement only with titles or fame

What do you see as the biggest advantages and disadvantages of being a doctor?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises both rewards and demands of being a doctor

Middle

- Explains a benefit such as meaningful patient relationships
- Examines a cost such as responsibility, uncertainty or working patterns

End

- Explains how the balance informs their career choice

Mistakes to avoid

- Romanticising the job or presenting only disadvantages

What aspects of becoming a doctor are you most excited about?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names a specific aspect of medicine they anticipate enjoying

Middle

- Explains why learning, patient contact or problem-solving matters personally
- Connects enthusiasm to a realistic observation

End

- Acknowledges the effort behind that rewarding aspect

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying everything about medicine will be exciting

What aspects of a medical career concern you or appeal to you least?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies an honest concern about a medical career

Middle

- Explains why it could be difficult personally
- Describes preparation or support without pretending to remove the difficulty

End

- Shows a considered commitment despite uncertainty

Mistakes to avoid

- Disguising a boast as a concern

What might lead someone to leave medical practice after qualifying, and what does this tell you about the demands of the career?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises that leaving medicine can have varied reasons

Middle

- Discusses workload, health, family or alternative interests
- Distinguishes individual circumstances from systemic pressures

End

- Suggests supportive retention measures without judging those who leave

Mistakes to avoid

- Labelling departure a failure or assuming one universal cause

Compare a doctor's working life now with medical practice a century ago. Which changes have most affected the role?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Selects major changes rather than narrating a century of history

Middle

- Compares evidence, treatments and technology
- Discusses changing patient involvement and team roles

End

- Explains which change most altered doctors' responsibilities

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming older care was uniformly uncaring or modern care has no limits

Beyond diagnosing and treating illness, what other responsibilities do doctors have?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies responsibilities beyond diagnosis and treatment

Middle

- Explains teaching, prevention or advocacy with examples
- Includes accountability, records or service improvement

End

- Links wider duties to safer care

Mistakes to avoid

- Providing a list with no explanation of its importance

How would you explain what holistic or whole-person care means to you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines whole-person care around the individual's wider life

Middle

- Connects physical needs with psychological and social circumstances
- Explains how preferences or practical barriers change a care plan

End

- Shows how the patient helps define a suitable plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating holistic care as an alternative to evidence-based treatment

In what ways is technology changing the role of doctors?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a concrete technology changing medical work

Middle

- Explains its effect on diagnosis, administration or access
- Considers accuracy, privacy and digital exclusion

End

- Keeps human judgement and accountability visible

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming technology inevitably replaces doctors

Which people might be included in the multidisciplinary team caring for a patient?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Builds a multidisciplinary team around a patient's needs

Middle

- Explains distinct contributions of nurses, pharmacists and allied professionals
- Includes community or social support where relevant

End

- Explains coordination and the patient's involvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing job titles without their roles or treating doctors as the only decision-makers

Why do you think teaching is an important part of medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how teaching supports safe medical practice

Middle

- Connects knowledge sharing with team competence
- Discusses patient understanding and the teacher's own learning

End

- Links teaching to sustained standards of care

Mistakes to avoid

- Restricting teaching to formal lectures

Which people do doctors have a responsibility to teach?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies different audiences doctors teach

Middle

- Distinguishes students and colleagues from patients and carers
- Adapts content to each audience's needs and consent

End

- Checks whether the learning was useful

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all audiences need the same technical detail

Would you personally like teaching to form part of your future medical career? Why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Gives an honest personal view on teaching in their career

Middle

- Uses an experience of helping someone learn
- Recognises teaching requires preparation and feedback

End

- Explains how they could develop as a teacher

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming enjoyment alone guarantees effective teaching

What do you imagine day-to-day life as a medical student is actually like?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Describes a realistic mixture of study, placement and personal life

Middle

- Recognises independent preparation and variable schedules
- Discusses peer learning, assessment and rest

End

- Identifies how they would adapt to that routine

Mistakes to avoid

- Portraying medical school as either constant studying or only hospital work

In what ways have the responsibilities of nurses and other healthcare professionals changed over time?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises evolving expertise across healthcare professions

Middle

- Discusses expanded or specialist responsibilities with careful examples
- Explains training, supervision and collaborative boundaries

End

- Connects role development to patients' needs

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating all professionals as interchangeable or subordinate helpers

How do hospital services and community care each contribute to meeting patients' needs? Discuss where healthcare takes place.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes hospital and community settings

Middle

- Explains specialist acute care alongside prevention and ongoing support
- Discusses handovers and continuity between settings

End

- Matches the setting to patient needs rather than prestige

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming healthcare occurs mainly on hospital wards

Which challenges do you expect to face during a medical career?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies likely professional and personal challenges

Middle

- Explores uncertainty, emotional demands or workload in depth
- Explains realistic coping and supervision

End

- Recognises that support needs can change over training

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming resilience means being unaffected by distress

How might you manage the pressures associated with studying and practising medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises pressure as something to manage proactively

Middle

- Explains prioritisation, rest and boundaries
- Names early support routes when usual strategies fail

End

- Describes reassessment rather than endless endurance

Mistakes to avoid

- Relying only on working harder

Describe a medical or healthcare issue you have recently read about.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Introduces a specific healthcare issue and where they read about it

Middle

- Explains the issue in their own words
- Distinguishes the source's evidence from opinion and identifies an implication

End

- Reflects on what the reading changed or left uncertain

Mistakes to avoid

- Repeating an unverified headline as established fact

What could make a healthcare setting stressful for patients or staff, and how might that stress develop into anger or aggression?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies stressors for both patients and staff

Middle

- Connects uncertainty, pain, delay or workload with emotional reactions
- Explains calm communication and safety responses

End

- Distinguishes understanding anger from accepting abuse

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming distressed patients or excusing threatening behaviour

What do you feel makes medicine different from many other careers?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a distinctive combination of features in medicine

Middle

- Explains science, close human contact and consequential decisions
- Respects that other careers also serve people

End

- Relates that combination to their personal choice

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming medicine uniquely involves compassion or responsibility

Which qualities distinguish an excellent doctor from an average one?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines excellence beyond factual knowledge

Middle

- Explains judgement, communication and reliability with examples
- Recognises reflective improvement and collaboration

End

- Connects excellence to patient experience and safety

Mistakes to avoid

- Describing an excellent doctor as infallible

A clinician has excellent medical knowledge but struggles to explain decisions. How would you weigh communication against clinical expertise when judging their care?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises communication and expertise as interdependent

Middle

- Explains how poor explanation affects understanding and consent
- Acknowledges that warmth cannot compensate for unsafe decisions

End

- Proposes developing both skills through support and feedback

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing technical ability or communication as sufficient alone

How would you explain what patient-centred care means?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines care around the patient's needs and preferences

Middle

- Explains shared decisions and accessible information
- Considers practical circumstances affecting agreed care

End

- Checks whether the plan reflects what matters to the patient

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating patient-centred care with granting every request

Why do you think empathy is important in medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains empathy as understanding another person's perspective

Middle

- Shows how listening reveals concerns and barriers
- Connects understanding with a useful response

End

- Links empathy to trust and individualised care

Mistakes to avoid

- Confusing empathy with pity or claiming identical experience

Can empathy ever make a doctor's work more difficult? Discuss how to remain compassionate while making sound clinical decisions.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges emotional involvement can complicate decisions

Middle

- Considers distress, over-identification and unequal attention
- Explains supervision and reflective boundaries

End

- Maintains compassion alongside evidence and fair judgement

Mistakes to avoid

- Suggesting emotional detachment is the only safe approach

How would you explain what professionalism means in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines professionalism through accountable conduct

Middle

- Uses honesty, reliability and respect as practical examples
- Explains competence and appropriate boundaries

End

- Shows professionalism persists under pressure

Mistakes to avoid

- Reducing professionalism to appearance or seniority

Think about the responsibilities attached to a doctor's role beyond a single consultation. Who else is affected by their decisions?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies people affected beyond the consultation

Middle

- Explains effects on carers, colleagues and other patients
- Considers stewardship, public trust and population health

End

- Balances individual duties with wider responsibilities

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring consequences outside the consulting room

How could doctors balance compassion with professional boundaries?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises compassion can coexist with clear boundaries

Middle

- Explains respectful limits on contact or personal involvement
- Offers appropriate support without dependence

End

- Seeks advice if boundaries become unclear

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating friendship or favours as necessary proof of care

How would you explain what continuity of care means, and why does it matter?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines continuity across time, relationships and information

Middle

- Explains how familiarity and reliable records aid decisions
- Discusses handovers when the same clinician is unavailable

End

- Links continuity to coordinated, safer care

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming continuity requires one doctor to provide all care

How could doctors work effectively with nurses, pharmacists, physiotherapists and other healthcare professionals?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises colleagues' distinct expertise

Middle

- Explains clear handovers, shared goals and respectful challenge
- Includes role clarity and closed-loop communication

End

- Checks that responsibility for next steps is understood

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming collaboration means everyone performs the same role

Why does a doctor need to keep learning throughout their career?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains why initial training cannot cover an entire career

Middle

- Discusses changing evidence and skills
- Uses feedback or audit to identify learning needs

End

- Connects continued learning to maintained competence

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating qualification as the end of learning

How could doctors respond when medical evidence or guidance changes?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges that established practice may need revision

Middle

- Checks the quality and relevance of new guidance
- Discusses changes with the team and affected patients

End

- Reviews implementation and outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Adopting every new study immediately or refusing to reconsider habits

Which role should doctors play in disease prevention?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies prevention as part of a doctor's role

Middle

- Discusses appropriate advice, screening or vaccination without invented eligibility rules
- Recognises social barriers to acting on advice

End

- Connects individual support with wider prevention efforts

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming patients for preventable illness

Should expectations about healthy behaviour apply to doctors outside work? Explain how you would balance their example to patients with their private lives.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Sets out role-modelling alongside doctors' private lives

Middle

- Considers credibility and realistic human limitations
- Distinguishes private choices from impairment affecting safe care

End

- Offers proportionate expectations without demanding perfection

Mistakes to avoid

- Using a doctor's appearance as evidence of clinical competence

Which responsibilities do doctors have towards public health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Connects clinical practice to population health

Middle

- Explains surveillance, prevention or advocacy
- Considers collaboration with public-health teams and communities

End

- Recognises doctors cannot change population health alone

Mistakes to avoid

- Limiting public health to telling individuals to behave better

How would you explain what advocacy means in the context of being a doctor?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines advocacy as helping patients' needs and rights be heard

Middle

- Gives an example of addressing an access barrier
- Keeps the patient's preferences central

End

- Explains appropriate escalation or system improvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Speaking over patients while claiming to represent them

How could a doctor respond when they do not know the answer to something?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges uncertainty honestly

Middle

- Checks reliable information and seeks suitable supervision
- Explains limits to the patient without guessing

End

- Returns with an answer or clear follow-up plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Bluffing to preserve authority

Why do you think recognising your own limitations is important in medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how recognising limits protects patients

Middle

- Identifies when a task exceeds competence
- Seeks supervision while taking responsibility for learning

End

- Shows appropriate help-seeking supports professional growth

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating asking for help with incompetence

What would you include when explaining clinical leadership?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines leadership through shared clinical goals

Middle

- Explains listening, coordination and accountability
- Includes speaking up and adapting to colleagues' expertise

End

- Connects leadership with team performance and safe care

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating leadership with being most senior or loudest

How could doctors contribute to improving healthcare systems as well as treating individual patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies an improvement beyond an individual consultation

Middle

- Explains audit, quality improvement or service redesign
- Involves staff and patients and considers feasibility

End

- Names a way to measure whether care improved

Mistakes to avoid

- Suggesting system improvement needs only individual effort

Why are you especially interested in studying at this particular medical school?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies specific researched reasons for this school

Middle

- Connects course or placement features with personal learning needs
- Explains a contribution they could make

End

- Gives a considered account of fit

Mistakes to avoid

- Generic praise that could name any university

Many universities offer similar teaching methods. What in particular attracts you to this course?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses features that distinguish this course in practice

Middle

- Explains how timing, delivery or placement context matters personally
- Supports fit with experience of learning

End

- Prioritises the most meaningful feature

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing teaching labels without explaining what makes the course attractive

Which aspects of this medical school appeal to you most?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Selects the school's most appealing features

Middle

- Explains why each matters to study or wellbeing
- Balances academic and wider community considerations

End

- Identifies the strongest reason for fit

Mistakes to avoid

- Relying on rankings alone

Which aspects of this course would suit you least, and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a genuine less-suitable course feature respectfully

Middle

- Explains the personal difficulty it could create
- Suggests realistic adaptation and support

End

- Balances the concern against overall suitability

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming the course has no drawbacks or dismissing its teaching

What do you understand so far by problem-based learning or PBL?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains PBL as learning through a problem in a small group

Middle

- Describes identifying learning needs and independent investigation
- Explains sharing findings with facilitation

End

- Recognises learner responsibility and collaboration

Mistakes to avoid

- Describing PBL as unguided guessing without study

In what ways does problem-based learning differ from more traditional teaching?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Sets up a comparison of problem-led and lecture-led learning

Middle

- Compares learner responsibility and sequencing of knowledge
- Considers discussion, feedback and independent preparation

End

- Recognises courses can combine approaches

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting all teaching as a strict PBL-versus-lectures choice

What do you see as the main advantages of problem-based learning?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a benefit specific to problem-based learning

Middle

- Explains contextual understanding and active inquiry
- Connects teamwork with sharing and evaluating knowledge

End

- Relates benefits to effective participation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming group work automatically produces deep learning

Which potential disadvantages does PBL have?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a plausible limitation of PBL

Middle

- Discusses uneven participation or uncertainty about coverage
- Explains facilitation and preparation as mitigations

End

- Recognises suitability varies between learners and tasks

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling PBL easy or entirely unsupported

What do you see as the strengths of lecture-based teaching?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies what structured lectures can do well

Middle

- Explains clear foundations and efficient expert overview
- Discusses how lectures can support later application

End

- Recognises benefit depends on engagement and follow-up

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming attendance alone produces understanding

What do you see as the limitations of relying heavily on lectures?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises limits of relying mainly on lectures

Middle

- Explains passive learning and limited individual feedback
- Suggests retrieval, discussion or practical application

End

- Describes a more balanced learning approach

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming lectures have no educational value

How would you define an integrated medical curriculum?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines integration between scientific and clinical learning

Middle

- Explains connections across subjects or stages
- Uses a clinical problem to illustrate linked learning

End

- Distinguishes integration from simply adding placements

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating an integrated curriculum as having no structure

Which advantages can an integrated course offer?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the value of connecting science with practice

Middle

- Explains relevance, revisiting concepts and clinical application
- Discusses how links can support retention

End

- Acknowledges effective coordination is needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming integration removes the need to learn basic science

Which difficulties might students encounter on an integrated course?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a difficulty in learning interconnected material

Middle

- Explains switching contexts or recognising knowledge gaps
- Suggests a study map and targeted support

End

- Checks that foundations remain secure

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming students must understand everything immediately

What do you already know about the structure of this medical degree?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Outlines the degree's verified stages and teaching pattern

Middle

- Explains placement timing and assessment at an appropriate level
- Separates known course facts from assumptions

End

- Connects course structure to preparation

Mistakes to avoid

- Inventing modules or placement arrangements

Why do you think this course suits the way you learn?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains their learning preferences with evidence

Middle

- Matches a concrete course method to an effective past strategy
- Acknowledges the need to develop other approaches

End

- Shows flexible fit rather than a fixed learning label

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming they can learn in only one way

How might you adapt if the teaching style were different from what you were used to?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges an unfamiliar teaching approach may take adjustment

Middle

- Seeks clarification and feedback early
- Trials active study methods and peer support

End

- Reviews which changes improve understanding

Mistakes to avoid

- Rejecting the course because its style is unfamiliar

Medicine involves a large amount of independent study. How might you manage that?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Sets out a manageable independent-study routine

Middle

- Prioritises learning objectives and active recall
- Builds review, breaks and help-seeking into the timetable

End

- Checks progress and adjusts workload

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating independent study with studying entirely alone

How might you balance academic work, clinical placements and life outside medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises competing academic, placement and personal needs

Middle

- Plans around fixed commitments and realistic study blocks
- Protects recovery and communicates clashes early

End

- Reviews balance as placement demands change

Mistakes to avoid

- Sacrificing all personal life as a long-term strategy

How might you approach a topic you found particularly difficult?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies what specifically makes the topic difficult

Middle

- Breaks the problem into prerequisites and smaller tasks
- Uses alternative explanations, practice and feedback

End

- Tests understanding before moving on

Mistakes to avoid

- Repeatedly rereading without checking comprehension

After starting medical school, you find that your marks are well below your previous standard. How would you work out what is going wrong and decide what to do?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Responds to lower marks with investigation rather than self-blame

Middle

- Reviews feedback, study methods and wellbeing
- Seeks academic advice and makes a targeted plan

End

- Sets a review date to assess improvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Hiding the difficulty or simply adding more hours

How might you describe your communication skills?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Gives a balanced assessment of their communication

Middle

- Uses an example of listening and adapting a message
- Recognises feedback or a specific limitation

End

- Identifies how they are improving

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming to communicate perfectly with everyone

In what ways have you developed your ability to communicate with others?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies an experience that developed communication

Middle

- Explains practice, feedback and a change in approach
- Shows how another person's understanding improved

End

- Describes a next development goal

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing public-speaking activities without showing learning

Would you personally describe yourself as empathetic? Why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains empathy through a specific interaction

Middle

- Shows how they explored rather than assumed feelings
- Describes a response shaped by the other person's needs

End

- Reflects on the limits of understanding another person

Mistakes to avoid

- Using self-description alone as proof of empathy

Describe a situation where good communication changed the outcome.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Briefly sets out the situation and communication problem

Middle

- Explains their actual communication choices
- Links those choices with an observable outcome

End

- Identifies what they would repeat or change

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming success without showing how communication contributed

How might you communicate with a patient who was frightened?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges fear and invites the patient's concerns

Middle

- Listens before offering information
- Uses calm explanations in manageable amounts

End

- Checks understanding and agrees support

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering false reassurance before understanding the fear

How might you approach a patient who was angry or frustrated?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges frustration while considering immediate safety

Middle

- Explores the cause without blame or confrontation
- Explains what can realistically be done and sets respectful boundaries

End

- Agrees next steps or seeks help if risk escalates

Mistakes to avoid

- Arguing, making impossible promises or tolerating threats

How might you communicate with someone who did not understand medical terminology?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks the patient's starting understanding

Middle

- Replaces jargon with everyday terms
- Explains one idea at a time using a suitable example

End

- Uses teach-back sensitively to check clarity

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming silence means understanding

How could you explain a complicated medical idea without sounding patronising?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Asks what the patient already knows and wants explained

Middle

- Uses a simple accurate analogy without infantilising
- Invites correction and questions

End

- Checks understanding without testing or embarrassing them

Mistakes to avoid

- Oversimplifying so far that the explanation becomes inaccurate

What tends to make someone a good listener?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines listening as active attention to meaning

Middle

- Describes open questions, pauses and clarification
- Recognises verbal and nonverbal cues without assuming their meaning

End

- Summarises to check their interpretation

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating listening with remaining silent while planning a reply

When might listening carefully achieve more than giving advice or explanations?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a situation where being heard is the immediate need

Middle

- Explains how premature advice can miss the concern
- Uses an example of exploring feelings or priorities

End

- Checks whether advice is wanted before offering it

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming every upset person wants a solution immediately

How might you respond to a patient who began crying during a consultation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Pauses and acknowledges the patient's distress

Middle

- Allows silence and offers appropriate comfort
- Asks gently what they need without forcing disclosure

End

- Continues at the patient's pace with support

Mistakes to avoid

- Rushing past tears to finish the consultation

How might you communicate with someone whose first language was not English?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Asks about language needs and preferred communication

Middle

- Arranges an appropriate interpreter for substantive discussions
- Speaks directly to the patient using short clear sentences

End

- Checks understanding and provides accessible follow-up

Mistakes to avoid

- Relying automatically on children or relatives to interpret sensitive care

How might you adapt your communication for a child?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Establishes the child's age, understanding and comfort

Middle

- Speaks directly to the child with suitable language or demonstration
- Includes carers while attending to the child's views

End

- Checks understanding and explains the next step

Mistakes to avoid

- Speaking only to the adult or assuming age alone determines understanding

How would you adapt a consultation to an older patient's individual communication needs?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Asks about this patient's individual communication needs

Middle

- Adapts for hearing, vision, language or processing preferences
- Allows time without patronising or assuming impairment

End

- Checks the patient understood and had a voice

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all older patients have cognitive or hearing difficulties

A patient comes away from a conversation with a different understanding from the one you intended. How would you find out what they understood and put the misunderstanding right?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Invites the patient to explain their understanding

Middle

- Identifies the mismatch without blaming them
- Rephrases and corrects the specific misunderstanding

End

- Checks the revised understanding and agreed plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Repeating the same explanation more loudly

How might you respond if a patient strongly disagreed with you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores the reason for disagreement respectfully

Middle

- Checks shared facts and the patient's priorities
- Explains reasoning and reasonable alternatives without coercion

End

- Agrees a safe next step while respecting informed choice

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating disagreement as disobedience

How could body language influence a clinical consultation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how posture, expression and distance can affect comfort

Middle

- Gives examples of attentive and potentially unwelcoming behaviour
- Recognises culture, disability and individual differences

End

- Checks meaning rather than reading intentions from body language

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming eye contact reliably measures honesty or empathy

Which factors might prevent effective communication between a doctor and patient?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies barriers in the patient, setting and clinician's approach

Middle

- Explains language, sensory needs, anxiety or jargon
- Matches each barrier with a practical adjustment

End

- Checks whether adjustments enabled shared understanding

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming communication failure entirely on the patient

How could doctors build trust with patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies trust as something earned through behaviour

Middle

- Explains honesty, listening, confidentiality and reliability
- Shows how keeping promises or acknowledging uncertainty builds confidence

End

- Recognises trust takes time and follow-through

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating professional status as automatic entitlement to trust

What can damage trust between a doctor and a patient, and how might their relationship deteriorate?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a concrete way trust can be damaged

Middle

- Explains how dismissal, inconsistency or secrecy affects disclosure
- Describes how poor communication can reinforce deterioration

End

- Suggests acknowledgement, repair and reliable follow-through

Mistakes to avoid

- Expecting an apology alone to restore trust immediately

What tends to make you an effective team member?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names a contribution they make to a team

Middle

- Supports reliability, listening or flexibility with an example
- Shows awareness of others' expertise and needs

End

- Identifies a teamwork skill still developing

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling themselves effective without evidence

Describe a time when you contributed successfully to a team.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Sets out a specific team goal and their role

Middle

- Explains their contribution alongside others' work
- Describes how coordination affected the result

End

- Reflects on a transferable teamwork lesson

Mistakes to avoid

- Taking sole credit for a shared outcome

Which qualities make someone a strong team leader?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines leadership around enabling a shared goal

Middle

- Explains listening, clear direction and fair delegation
- Includes accountability and responsiveness to feedback

End

- Recognises different situations need different leadership

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating confidence with leadership competence

Describe an occasion when you demonstrated leadership.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Briefly introduces a situation requiring leadership

Middle

- Shows how they involved people and organised action
- Explains a decision and its effect on the group

End

- Reflects on what their leadership could improve

Mistakes to avoid

- Merely naming a leadership title

Do you see yourself naturally as more of a leader or a team member?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Gives a nuanced account of their preferred team role

Middle

- Uses evidence of leading or contributing
- Explains when another person's expertise should guide the group

End

- Shows willingness to switch roles

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting followership as inferior

What tends to make a team function effectively?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies shared purpose and clear responsibilities

Middle

- Explains trust, information sharing and coordinated action
- Discusses constructive feedback and inclusion

End

- Shows how a team checks progress

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming a group of talented individuals automatically works well

What do you see as the advantages of working in a team?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a benefit arising from combining contributions

Middle

- Explains complementary skills and error checking
- Discusses support and shared workload with an example

End

- Recognises benefits depend on coordination

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming teamwork always saves time

Which difficulties can arise when working as part of a team?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a realistic teamwork difficulty

Middle

- Explains role confusion, uneven effort or disagreement
- Pairs the problem with a practical response

End

- Recognises reflection can improve team functioning

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating conflict as proof a team cannot work

How might you manage disagreement within a team?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies what the disagreement concerns

Middle

- Listens to each perspective and returns to the shared objective
- Compares options using agreed criteria

End

- Agrees a decision and a review or escalation route

Mistakes to avoid

- Taking sides before hearing the reasons

What would you do next if one team member was contributing much less than everyone else?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores reduced contribution privately without assuming laziness

Middle

- Asks about barriers and clarifies expectations
- Agrees achievable responsibilities and support

End

- Reviews progress and escalates persistent issues fairly

Mistakes to avoid

- Publicly shaming the member or silently doing all their work

What would you do next if two members of your team strongly disagreed with one another?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Keeps the discussion respectful and identifies the disputed issue

Middle

- Gives both members space to explain
- Finds shared goals and compares evidence for options

End

- Agrees a workable resolution without personal blame

Mistakes to avoid

- Demanding compromise regardless of safety or quality

How might you respond if the team rejected your idea?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Responds to rejection without defensiveness

Middle

- Asks for the team's reasoning and evaluates criticism
- Clarifies useful aspects once, then supports the agreed approach

End

- Reflects on what changed their view

Mistakes to avoid

- Withdrawing effort because their idea was not selected

How might you manage a team member who dominated every discussion?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises domination is limiting others' contribution

Middle

- Uses polite redirection and an agreed turn-taking approach
- Invites other views without humiliating the dominant member

End

- Maintains focus on the group's task

Mistakes to avoid

- Responding by talking over them even more

How might you encourage a quieter member of a group to contribute?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Creates a low-pressure opportunity for the quieter member

Middle

- Uses an open invitation and allows thinking time
- Offers another contribution route if appropriate

End

- Acknowledges their idea and includes it in decisions

Mistakes to avoid

- Forcing public participation or equating quietness with lack of ability

Someone speaks frequently in a group but rarely helps others contribute. What else would you look for before calling them a good leader?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes frequent speech from effective leadership

Middle

- Looks for listening, inclusion and useful coordination
- Assesses whether the person improves group decisions

End

- Judges leadership by team outcomes and conduct

Mistakes to avoid

- Using airtime as the main evidence of leadership

To what extent can leadership involve stepping back rather than taking control?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains when stepping back can serve a team

Middle

- Recognises expertise in others and delegates meaningfully
- Remains accountable and available for support

End

- Balances restraint with action when direction is needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Confusing stepping back with abandoning responsibility

How might you lead a team under significant time pressure?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies the urgent goal and available time

Middle

- Prioritises essential work and delegates clear tasks
- Uses brief updates and welcomes safety concerns

End

- Checks completion and reviews the process afterwards

Mistakes to avoid

- Rushing without checking understanding or silencing objections

Describe a time when your team did not perform as well as you hoped.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Describes a specific disappointing team outcome

Middle

- Acknowledges their own part and relevant team factors
- Explains how the group responded

End

- Identifies an actionable change for future teamwork

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming another member for everything

What lessons did you take from working with someone whose personality was very different from yours?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a meaningful difference in working styles

Middle

- Explains how they adapted communication or roles
- Shows what they learned from the other person's approach

End

- Describes how that learning changed later collaboration

Mistakes to avoid

- Labelling a different personality as inherently difficult

Why does effective teamwork matter in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Links teamwork to coordinated patient care

Middle

- Explains complementary expertise and reliable handovers
- Shows how speaking up can prevent errors

End

- Recognises shared goals alongside individual accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming teamwork removes each professional's responsibility

How would you organise your time when you have several competing priorities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Identifies deadlines, consequences and task urgency

Middle

- Breaks work into realistic blocks
- Communicates clashes and seeks help where needed

End

- Reassesses priorities when circumstances change

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating all tasks as equally urgent

How might you describe your organisational skills?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Describes an organisational method they actually use

Middle

- Shows it working in a concrete example
- Recognises a limitation and how they adjust

End

- Explains how they check that commitments are met

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing apps without explaining the process

Which activities or hobbies do you enjoy outside your studies?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names an authentic interest outside study

Middle

- Explains what they enjoy and how they participate
- Shows its place in rest, relationships or growth

End

- Keeps the answer personal and proportionate

Mistakes to avoid

- Forcing every hobby into an artificial medical connection

Describe a meaningful non-academic project you have taken part in.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Introduces the non-academic project's purpose and their role

Middle

- Explains their specific actions and a challenge
- Describes the project's effect on others or themselves

End

- Reflects on why it mattered

Mistakes to avoid

- Spending the whole answer describing the project rather than their involvement

How would you normally respond to stress?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises their usual signs of stress

Middle

- Explains specific coping strategies and their limits
- Includes support if pressure persists

End

- Reviews what has helped in past stressful periods

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming never to feel stress

Which lessons have your hobbies or interests taught you that could be useful in medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a lesson from a genuine hobby

Middle

- Uses a concrete experience of practice, teamwork or patience
- Explains a plausible transfer to medical learning

End

- Acknowledges where further development is needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming a hobby alone proves clinical suitability

What do you consider your main strengths?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses a small number of evidenced strengths

Middle

- Uses specific behaviour to substantiate each
- Explains how a strength benefits others

End

- Recognises that strengths still require development

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving flattering adjectives without examples

What personal qualities would help you become a good doctor?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Selects personal qualities relevant to good doctoring

Middle

- Connects an example to listening, judgement or reliability
- Recognises limits of applicant-level experience

End

- Explains how training would develop those qualities

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting confidence as proof of clinical competence

What do you feel you would bring to our medical school?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a realistic contribution to the school community

Middle

- Supports it with an existing skill or interest
- Explains how peers or local communities might benefit

End

- Shows willingness to learn from others too

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering only what the school can provide them

What three words would you use to describe yourself?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Gives exactly three distinct descriptive words

Middle

- Supports each with brief credible evidence
- Avoids contradictory or purely boastful claims

End

- Shows a coherent but not perfect self-portrait

Mistakes to avoid

- Spending the answer listing more than three labels

How do you think your friends would describe you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Offers a plausible view grounded in friendships

Middle

- Uses feedback or behaviour friends have noticed
- Recognises a balanced or less flattering aspect

End

- Connects their description with self-awareness

Mistakes to avoid

- Inventing universal praise from everyone they know

Which values would you want people to associate with you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names values they want associated with their conduct

Middle

- Explains how those values affect choices
- Uses an example where acting on a value required effort

End

- Recognises values must be demonstrated consistently

Mistakes to avoid

- Naming values without showing their practical meaning

What parts of your personality are well suited to medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies personality traits relevant to medicine

Middle

- Links traits to concrete behaviours and patient or team needs
- Recognises situations where a trait may need managing

End

- Shows openness to development through training

Mistakes to avoid

- Suggesting only one personality type can be a good doctor

Which skills have you gained through employment or volunteering that would transfer to medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a transferable skill from employment or volunteering

Middle

- Explains a specific responsibility and what it taught
- Connects it to medical study or interacting with people

End

- Acknowledges the difference between transferable and clinical skills

Mistakes to avoid

- Exaggerating non-clinical experience into medical competence

Do you tend to work better independently or as part of a group?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- States a preference while recognising task dependence

Middle

- Gives evidence of effective independent and group work
- Explains when collaboration or focused solo work is useful

End

- Shows flexibility according to the objective

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing the value of the less-preferred approach

What is one area of yourself that you are currently trying to improve?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names one genuine development area

Middle

- Explains its effect using a specific example
- Describes actions already being taken

End

- Defines how improvement will be recognised

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering a disguised strength such as caring too much

If you could improve two personal qualities, what would they be and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies two distinct qualities to improve

Middle

- Explains why each matters personally
- Gives a practical development step for each

End

- Prioritises and reviews progress realistically

Mistakes to avoid

- Naming weaknesses without any plan to address them

Who has had the greatest influence on the person you are today?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies an influential person and the nature of their influence

Middle

- Uses a specific interaction or example
- Explains how it shaped a value or decision

End

- Shows their own reflective response to that influence

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving a biography without explaining personal impact

Which qualities make someone an effective teacher?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines effective teaching through learner understanding

Middle

- Explains clarity, adaptation and useful feedback
- Recognises psychological safety and checking comprehension

End

- Connects teaching quality with learning outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating expertise or charisma alone with good teaching

Describe a teacher or mentor who had an impact on you.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Introduces a teacher or mentor and a specific encounter

Middle

- Explains what their approach enabled
- Describes a change in confidence, understanding or behaviour

End

- Identifies an approach they would carry forward

Mistakes to avoid

- Only saying the mentor was inspiring

Describe an important decision you have had to make.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- States the decision and why it mattered

Middle

- Compares options and relevant information
- Explains their reasoning and ownership of the choice

End

- Reflects on the outcome and what they learned

Mistakes to avoid

- Describing only the result without the decision process

Which achievement are you most proud of?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Names an achievement and its personal significance

Middle

- Explains effort, obstacles and their own contribution
- Acknowledges help from others

End

- Reflects on growth beyond the award or result

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming prestige alone explains pride

How would you respond when somebody criticises your work?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Listens to criticism without immediate defensiveness

Middle

- Clarifies specific examples and separates tone from useful content
- Agrees a realistic change or respectfully queries unclear feedback

End

- Checks whether their work improves

Mistakes to avoid

- Accepting every criticism uncritically or rejecting it all

How would you deal with conflict?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies the conflict and those affected

Middle

- Listens privately and separates the issue from the person
- Seeks shared interests and a proportionate resolution

End

- Escalates unresolved safety concerns appropriately

Mistakes to avoid

- Avoiding the issue until it worsens

Briefly describe a situation in which you changed your opinion after hearing another perspective.

General

- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally, without reciting the framework
- Shows genuine listening
- Demonstrates humility and openness
- Strong reflection on what was learnt

Start

- Briefly explains the situation
- Clearly states their original opinion
- Keeps unnecessary background short

Middle

- Explains the other person’s perspective
- Shows how they listened and considered it
- Explains specifically what changed their opinion
- Describes the outcome

End

- Explains what they learnt
- Shows how the experience changed their future behaviour
- Demonstrates greater openness to other perspectives

Mistakes to avoid

- Their opinion never actually changes
- Too much description with little reflection
- Dismisses or criticises the other person
- Changes opinion simply to avoid disagreement

Describe a mistake you made and what you learned from it.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Acknowledges a specific mistake and their responsibility

Middle

- Explains immediate correction and communication
- Identifies why it happened without excuses

End

- Describes a preventive change and evidence of learning

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing an example with no genuine mistake

Describe a book, film, podcast or article that made you think differently.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Identifies a work and the idea that challenged them

Middle

- Explains their previous thinking
- Evaluates the argument rather than retelling the plot

End

- Describes what changed and any remaining doubts

Mistakes to avoid

- Summarising content without a personal intellectual response

What evidence from your experience suggests you can sustain your effort and wellbeing through a long medical training programme?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Uses experience of sustained effort as evidence

Middle

- Explains adapting after setbacks and protecting wellbeing
- Acknowledges support and limits

End

- Relates the lesson cautiously to long training

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming one success proves they will never struggle

Which situations tend to frustrate or anger you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a genuine trigger for frustration

Middle

- Explains how they notice and regulate their reaction
- Considers others' circumstances before responding

End

- Reflects on preventing an unhelpful response

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming others or claiming never to feel anger

How would you recognise when you are becoming overwhelmed?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies personal early warning signs of overload

Middle

- Discusses changes in sleep, concentration or behaviour without self-diagnosis
- Uses feedback and workload review

End

- Acts early and seeks support if signs persist

Mistakes to avoid

- Waiting until functioning is severely affected before acknowledging difficulty

What would you do next if you were struggling academically or emotionally at medical school?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges difficulty and checks immediate support needs

Middle

- Contacts appropriate academic or wellbeing support
- Makes a manageable plan and involves trusted people

End

- Reviews progress and escalates urgent concerns

Mistakes to avoid

- Trying to conceal all difficulties and cope alone

How might you support a friend who appeared to be struggling?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Approaches the friend privately with a gentle observation

Middle

- Listens without assuming the cause
- Offers practical support and encourages appropriate help

End

- Follows up and seeks urgent help if safety is at risk

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising absolute secrecy regardless of risk

How would you explain what resilience means to you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines resilience as adapting and recovering

Middle

- Uses an example of adjustment after difficulty
- Includes rest, reflection and support

End

- Recognises resilience develops and does not mean invulnerability

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating resilience with suppressing emotion

How does asking for support fit with your understanding of resilience? Discuss whether coping independently is always the best response to pressure.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains why support can be part of resilience

Middle

- Weighs independent problem-solving against recognising limits
- Shows how timely help can prevent deterioration

End

- Chooses support according to the situation

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating self-reliance as the only strong response

How would you maintain a healthy balance between achievement and wellbeing?

General

- Shows self-awareness
- Uses realistic strategies
- Recognises when support may be needed
- Links wellbeing to sustainable performance

Start

- Recognises both achievement and wellbeing are important
- Explains that balance requires active management
- Avoids suggesting that simply working harder is the answer

Middle

- Prioritises workload and manages time
- Maintains healthy activities and relationships outside work
- Recognises early signs of stress or overload
- Seeks support appropriately when needed

End

- Recognises strategies may need to change during difficult periods
- Links wellbeing to long-term performance
- Shows willingness to reflect and adapt

Mistakes to avoid

- Claims they never become stressed
- Glorifies overworking
- Suggests asking for help is weakness
- Only says “I would manage my time” without explaining how

What do you understand so far about how the NHS is structured?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the UK nation being discussed

Middle

- Distinguishes primary, hospital and community provision
- Explains planning, funding and delivery without inventing current structures

End

- Recognises structures change and differ across the UK

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating the NHS as one identical UK-wide organisation

In what ways does primary care differ from secondary and tertiary care?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines the three levels of care

Middle

- Illustrates first-contact, specialist and highly specialised services
- Explains referral and coordination between levels

End

- Matches the level to patient need

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating secondary care with every service outside general practice

Which role does a GP play within the NHS?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Describes the GP as a generalist providing first-contact and ongoing care

Middle

- Explains assessment, prevention and management of long-term conditions
- Includes referral and coordination

End

- Links continuity with knowing the patient's wider circumstances

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling a GP merely a gatekeeper for hospital care

How would you define the role of NHS England?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Places NHS England in the English health system

Middle

- Explains national responsibilities and their relationship with local bodies
- Distinguishes established functions from proposed or ongoing organisational changes

End

- Checks current official information before asserting a precise remit

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming the organisation runs all UK healthcare or that announced changes are already complete

How would you define an Integrated Care System?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines an ICS as a partnership across local health and care

Middle

- Distinguishes NHS commissioning from broader partnership working
- Explains joint planning around population need and inequalities

End

- Recognises that integration needs practical coordination

Mistakes to avoid

- Confusing an ICS with a single hospital or assuming boundaries never change

Which challenges currently face the NHS?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Selects a small number of linked NHS challenges

Middle

- Explains workforce, demand, access or funding pressures
- Considers effects on patients and realistic responses

End

- Identifies trade-offs rather than a single cure

Mistakes to avoid

- Using unsupported current figures or partisan slogans

How could the NHS decide which services to prioritise?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies need and expected benefit as priority-setting criteria

Middle

- Considers urgency, inequalities and opportunity cost
- Explains transparent consultation and evidence

End

- Justifies a consistent reviewable process

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing services by popularity alone

How could healthcare be funded?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Outlines taxation, insurance and direct-payment funding models

Middle

- Compares risk pooling, access and financial sustainability
- Recognises each model has trade-offs

End

- Offers a reasoned view on equitable funding

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming healthcare is free to provide because it is free at use

To what extent should private healthcare operate alongside a publicly funded NHS?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Frames the debate around access, capacity and fairness

Middle

- Considers additional capacity and patient choice
- Weighs workforce effects, fragmentation and unequal access

End

- Gives a conditional view with safeguards

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming private provision automatically increases total workforce capacity

What do you see as the potential advantages of having both public and private healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies potential benefits of a mixed system

Middle

- Explains choice, additional facilities or flexible capacity
- Clarifies when benefits depend on coordination and funding

End

- Acknowledges benefits must be demonstrated for patients

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting private provision as costless extra capacity

Which problems could arise from a mixed public-private healthcare system?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a risk created by mixed provision

Middle

- Explains unequal access, workforce competition or fragmented records
- Considers accountability and contract oversight

End

- Suggests safeguards addressing the named risk

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming every private service has identical effects

How would you explain what the term health inequality means to you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines differences in health outcomes or access between groups

Middle

- Uses a clear example
- Distinguishes observed differences from avoidable unfair disadvantage

End

- Explains why understanding causes matters

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating inequality only with differences in hospital treatment

Why do you think life expectancy and health outcomes can differ between different areas and communities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises health differences arise from interacting causes

Middle

- Connects income, housing or environment with exposure and access
- Avoids attributing community differences to personal choices alone

End

- Identifies information needed to explain a particular gap

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating a postcode as a biological cause

Which factors other than healthcare influence a person's health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names influences outside healthcare services

Middle

- Explains effects of housing, education, employment or relationships
- Connects living conditions with practical health choices

End

- Recognises cross-sector action is needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming better hospitals alone determine health

What do you see as the social determinants of health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines social determinants as conditions shaping people's lives

Middle

- Explains pathways from education, work and housing to health
- Includes unequal distribution of resources and opportunity

End

- Relates determinants to prevention and fairness

Mistakes to avoid

- Merely listing factors without explaining their effects

What practical steps could doctors take to reduce health inequalities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a practical barrier a doctor can help address

Middle

- Offers accessible communication or flexible support
- Links with community services and advocates for wider change

End

- Checks whether the intervention reduces the barrier

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising to solve poverty within a consultation

How could the NHS respond when demand for care is greater than the resources available?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the need to balance demand with available capacity

Middle

- Combines prioritisation with prevention and efficient pathways
- Considers workforce support and consequences of delay

End

- Explains transparent decisions and reassessment

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating rationing or extra funding as the only response

Which factors should be considered when deciding whether the NHS should fund a treatment?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Frames funding around evidence, need and value

Middle

- Considers benefit, harms, cost-effectiveness and alternatives
- Includes equity and uncertainty

End

- Supports transparent appraisal and review

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating the cheapest treatment with the best value

How should the NHS approach funding a procedure that some people describe as non-essential? Explain what you would want to understand before reaching a view.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Questions what non-essential means for this patient

Middle

- Explores functional, psychological and quality-of-life effects
- Weighs evidence, alternatives and opportunity cost

End

- Judges need fairly rather than by labels

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing a procedure solely because it is described as cosmetic or optional

How could waiting lists be prioritised?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Places urgency and risk of deterioration at the centre

Middle

- Considers waiting time, functional impact and changing need
- Uses consistent criteria and communicates delays

End

- Reassesses patients whose condition changes

Mistakes to avoid

- Using first-come-first-served regardless of clinical risk

Imagine an NHS funding decision where one option would reach more patients than another. Is the number of people treated enough to decide which option is fairest?

General

- Uses a FOR / AGAINST / BALANCED structure
- Recognises numbers are relevant but not sufficient
- Considers justice and fairness
- Recognises healthcare resources are limited

Start

- Directly states that patient numbers alone are not enough
- Identifies the tension between population benefit and individual need

Middle

- FOR prioritising numbers: more patients may benefit from limited resources
- AGAINST prioritising numbers alone: severity and size of benefit also matter
- Considers fairness and unmet need
- Considers what is lost when resources are used for one option rather than another

End

- Gives a balanced conclusion
- Explains that several factors should determine fairness
- Supports clear and consistent decision-making

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying treating more people is automatically fairest
- Ignoring severity or size of benefit
- Ignoring limited resources
- Treating certain patients as more deserving than others

To what extent should patients ever be expected to contribute financially towards their healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Sets out funding pressures alongside financial barriers to care

Middle

- Considers ability to pay and delayed presentation
- Discusses exemptions and administrative burdens

End

- Offers a justified position protecting essential access

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming charges affect all patients equally

What do you see as the arguments for and against charging for some NHS services?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Introduces both the case for charges and concerns about access

Middle

- Weighs revenue or demand effects against deterrence and inequality
- Considers collection costs and protection for vulnerable groups

End

- Reaches a balanced conditional conclusion

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming reduced use necessarily means reduced unnecessary use

How would you explain what clinical governance means?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines clinical governance as accountability for quality and safety

Middle

- Explains audit, learning, risk management and patient involvement
- Shows how these activities improve practice

End

- Connects governance with continuous improvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Reducing governance to paperwork or punishment

Why do you think clinical audit is important?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains audit as checking care against an agreed standard

Middle

- Describes measuring practice and identifying gaps
- Explains implementing change and re-auditing

End

- Links the cycle to improved care

Mistakes to avoid

- Confusing audit with collecting data without action

How would you define revalidation and why does it matter?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines revalidation as periodically demonstrating ongoing fitness to practise

Middle

- Explains reflection and evidence of maintaining standards
- Distinguishes it from a one-off qualification

End

- Links the process to professional accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming revalidation guarantees no future mistakes

How would you define informed consent?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains consent as an informed voluntary decision

Middle

- Discusses meaningful options, benefits, risks and understanding
- Recognises capacity and freedom to decline

End

- Treats consent as an ongoing conversation

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating a signed form with valid consent

How would you explain what patient capacity means?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains capacity as decision-specific and time-specific

Middle

- Describes understanding, retaining, weighing and communicating relevant information
- Recognises support may enable decision-making

End

- Avoids inferring incapacity from diagnosis or disagreement

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming an unwise choice proves lack of capacity

Why do you think confidentiality is central to healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how confidentiality supports trust and disclosure

Middle

- Describes respectful handling and appropriate access to information
- Acknowledges limited justified exceptions

End

- Balances privacy with proportionate safety duties

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising secrecy with no possible exceptions

In what situations might confidentiality need to be breached?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises disclosure without consent needs a justified basis

Middle

- Considers legal duties and serious risk with appropriate advice
- Limits disclosure to necessary information and recipients

End

- Documents reasoning and informs the patient where appropriate

Mistakes to avoid

- Sharing broadly because someone might find the information useful

What do you see as the four main principles of medical ethics?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names autonomy, beneficence, non-maleficence and justice

Middle

- Explains each in ordinary language
- Uses a brief example showing practical application

End

- Recognises principles can conflict

Mistakes to avoid

- Reciting names without explaining them

How would you explain what autonomy means in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines autonomy through informed voluntary choice

Middle

- Explains understandable options and respect for refusal
- Recognises support and freedom from pressure

End

- Distinguishes respecting choice from providing any requested intervention

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating autonomy as unlimited entitlement to treatment

How would you explain what beneficence means?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines beneficence as acting for the patient's benefit

Middle

- Explains benefit in relation to the patient's goals
- Weighs likely benefit against burdens and uncertainty

End

- Recognises good intentions need evidence and dialogue

Mistakes to avoid

- Using beneficence to automatically override informed refusal

How would you define non-maleficence?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines non-maleficence as avoiding or minimising harm

Middle

- Discusses harms of action and inaction
- Balances unavoidable risks against justified benefit

End

- Explains safeguards and review

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming any risk makes treatment unethical

How would you explain what justice means in medical decision-making?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines justice through fair treatment and allocation

Middle

- Distinguishes equal respect from identical resources
- Considers need, benefit and disadvantage

End

- Supports consistent transparent criteria

Mistakes to avoid

- Judging access by social worth

Describe how two of the four ethical principles could pull a clinical decision in different directions. How would you examine that tension?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses a clear conflict between two principles

Middle

- Applies both principles to the same clinical decision
- Examines consequences and relevant missing facts

End

- Offers a justified balance without pretending the tension disappears

Mistakes to avoid

- Naming four principles without examining the chosen conflict

You have considered the available options in an ethical dilemma, but each has a significant drawback. How would you decide what to do and justify your choice?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges that each available option has drawbacks

Middle

- Compares severity and likelihood of harms against benefits
- Considers preferences, duties and appropriate advice

End

- Explains a proportionate decision and how to review it

Mistakes to avoid

- Avoiding any decision because no option is perfect

An adult with capacity refuses life-saving treatment. How should a doctor respond to that decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the adult's informed refusal must be respected

Middle

- Checks understanding and voluntariness without assuming incapacity
- Explores concerns and acceptable alternatives

End

- Continues support and records the decision

Mistakes to avoid

- Forcing treatment solely because it could save life

In what situations can a doctor act against a patient's wishes?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises acting against wishes requires a specific lawful justification

Middle

- Distinguishes incapacity, emergencies and relevant statutory powers
- Seeks senior advice and the least restrictive appropriate approach

End

- Explains safeguards rather than claiming general authority

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming disagreement with a doctor removes a patient's rights

How could doctors approach decisions involving patients who lack capacity?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- First supports the person to participate in the decision

Middle

- Considers wishes, values and any applicable prior decisions or lawful representative
- Seeks an appropriate best-interests or equivalent jurisdiction-specific process

End

- Uses proportionate options and reviews capacity when relevant

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming relatives automatically decide everything

A patient's relatives want to decide which care the patient receives. What would you need to establish before deciding whether they should make that decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Establishes the patient's capacity and wishes first

Middle

- Clarifies relatives' legal authority rather than assuming it
- Listens to their knowledge of the patient's values

End

- Keeps the patient central and seeks advice if disputed

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating next-of-kin status as universal decision-making authority

How could doctors balance individual autonomy against public safety?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the actual public risk and the patient's rights

Middle

- Weighs necessity and proportionality
- Considers less restrictive options and relevant legal guidance

End

- Justifies limited action with review and explanation

Mistakes to avoid

- Overriding autonomy for vague public benefit

To what extent is it ever ethically acceptable for a doctor to withhold information from a patient?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Starts from honest information sharing and patient preferences

Middle

- Distinguishes pacing information from withholding it
- Examines exceptional circumstances with appropriate advice

End

- Preserves meaningful informed decision-making

Mistakes to avoid

- Withholding information merely because it may upset the patient

To what extent is lying to a patient ever justified?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises the threat lying poses to trust and autonomy

Middle

- Explores the reason truth feels difficult
- Considers sensitive timing and explanation as alternatives

End

- Supports honesty and seeks advice in exceptional cases

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling a convenient lie compassionate without examining consequences

In what situations might confidentiality need to be overridden?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies confidentiality as the starting duty

Middle

- Explains serious risk or a legal requirement as possible exceptions
- Seeks advice and considers consent or less intrusive alternatives

End

- Shares minimally and records the basis

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming family concern automatically justifies disclosure

A patient's lifestyle may have contributed to their illness. Discuss whether this should change the doctor's duty of care towards them.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Affirms care should not depend on moral blame

Middle

- Recognises addiction and social circumstances affect behaviour
- Distinguishes clinically relevant risk from punishment

End

- Maintains respectful evidence-based care

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating lifestyle-related illness as deserved

To what extent should lifestyle choices affect access to NHS treatment?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Separates clinical suitability from judgements about lifestyle

Middle

- Considers evidence about likely benefit and support for change
- Weighs fairness and unequal opportunities to change behaviour

End

- Uses consistent individual assessment

Mistakes to avoid

- Making blanket exclusions based on lifestyle labels

When deciding who receives treatment, should smoking history count against a patient? Explain how you would compare access for smokers and non-smokers.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Rejects smoking history as a simple moral ranking

Middle

- Considers any treatment-specific effect on risk or benefit
- Discusses cessation support and fair criteria

End

- Bases access on need and evidence

Mistakes to avoid

- Automatically placing all non-smokers ahead of smokers

Discuss how transplant services should consider patients with alcohol dependence. How would you assess whether their access is fair compared with other patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises alcohol dependence as a health condition

Middle

- Considers transplant benefit, clinical assessment and ongoing support
- Uses fair specialist criteria without invented eligibility rules

End

- Avoids stigma while acknowledging scarce organs

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating dependence as proof someone is undeserving

How would you explain what fairness means when healthcare resources are limited?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines fairness under scarcity as a reasoned allocation process

Middle

- Balances urgency, benefit and unmet need
- Considers transparency and opportunities to review decisions

End

- Acknowledges unavoidable opportunity costs

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming fair allocation can meet every need

To what extent is equality always the same as fairness?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Distinguishes identical treatment from support matched to need

Middle

- Uses an example where equal resources leave unequal access
- Explains equity without dismissing equal rights

End

- Justifies differences using relevant need

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming fairness always means giving everyone exactly the same

To what extent should younger patients ever be prioritised over older patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises equal dignity across ages

Middle

- Considers individual need and expected benefit
- Examines why age alone is an inadequate proxy

End

- Uses transparent clinically relevant criteria

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming an older person's life is worth less

To what extent should quality of life influence healthcare allocation decisions?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains why quality of life can matter to treatment benefit

Middle

- Includes the patient's own assessment
- Recognises uncertainty and risk of discriminatory assumptions

End

- Uses quality of life alongside other fair criteria

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming disability means poor quality of life

An expensive treatment is being considered for NHS funding. Whose judgement should determine whether it offers good value, and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises value assessment needs more than one perspective

Middle

- Combines independent evidence appraisal with clinical and patient input
- Considers public accountability and conflicts of interest

End

- Supports transparent decisions and review

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving sole authority to the manufacturer or the loudest campaign

A healthcare budget could fund costly care for one person or help a larger number of people. Explain how you would weigh the ethical arguments for each use of the money.

General

- Considers both sides fairly
- Uses a FOR / AGAINST / BALANCED structure
- Applies relevant ethical principles
- Avoids jumping immediately to one conclusion

Start

- Identifies the conflict between individual and population benefit
- Recognises that both options have reasonable ethical arguments

Middle

- FOR the individual: severity of need and potential individual benefit
- AGAINST the individual: high resource use means fewer resources elsewhere
- FOR the larger group: more people may benefit from limited resources
- AGAINST the larger group: numbers alone may disadvantage people with severe or uncommon needs

End

- Gives a balanced conclusion
- Explains that fairness involves more than simply counting patients
- Supports transparent and consistent decision-making

Mistakes to avoid

- Only discussing one side
- Automatically choosing the larger group
- Automatically choosing the individual
- Using ideas about who “deserves” treatment

An adult who has capacity declines a blood transfusion on religious grounds. They understand that they could die without it. Talk through how you would respond to their decision.

General

- Recognises and respects patient autonomy
- Ensures the decision is informed
- Communicates respectfully and empathetically
- Uses appropriate senior or team support

Start

- Identifies the conflict between autonomy and beneficence
- Acknowledges the seriousness of the situation
- Avoids judging the patient’s beliefs

Middle

- Confirms capacity and understanding
- Ensures the consequences of refusal are understood
- Explores the patient’s concerns and possible alternatives
- Seeks appropriate senior support where required

End

- Respects the refusal if the patient has capacity
- Documents the discussion and decision
- Continues appropriate care and support

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving treatment against the informed wishes of a patient with capacity
- Assuming treatment refusal means lack of capacity
- Pressuring or judging the patient
- Abandoning the patient after treatment is refused

An unconscious patient urgently needs a transfusion. Their records suggest they may reject blood products on religious grounds. What would you clarify before acting?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises urgency and uncertainty about prior wishes

Middle

- Checks for a valid applicable advance refusal and reliable records
- Seeks urgent senior advice without assuming religious identity proves refusal

End

- Explains a lawful proportionate emergency decision based on available facts

Mistakes to avoid

- Either ignoring an applicable refusal or delaying urgent help for speculation

Parents oppose a potentially life-saving blood transfusion for their child because of their beliefs. Explain the team's priorities in addressing this disagreement.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Prioritises the child's welfare while hearing the parents respectfully

Middle

- Clarifies urgency, alternatives and the child's involvement
- Seeks senior and legal support where disagreement persists

End

- Explains a safe timely process rather than deciding alone

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming parents' refusal always settles life-saving treatment for a child

Two people awaiting transplantation have comparable clinical need, and a donor organ is available for only one of them. What would a fair allocation process need to consider?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the need for a fair specialist allocation process

Middle

- Considers compatibility, likely benefit and established allocation criteria
- Avoids wealth, fame or moral worth as deciding factors

End

- Acknowledges uncertainty and transparent oversight

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing solely by age or who seems more deserving

A patient wants surgery despite a very low chance of success because of their current health. How would you discuss the disagreement with them?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores what the patient hopes surgery will achieve

Middle

- Explains likely benefits, risks and alternatives clearly
- Checks understanding and seeks a second or senior opinion where useful

End

- Agrees appropriate care without promising futile intervention

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating patient choice with an obligation to offer any operation

A new treatment could greatly improve one patient's life but use funds that could treat many others. How would you weigh this funding decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Acknowledges the individual's potential gain and wider opportunity cost

Middle

- Examines evidence, magnitude of benefit and alternatives
- Considers fair exceptions without abandoning consistent criteria

End

- Justifies a transparent funding process

Mistakes to avoid

- Letting an emotionally compelling story replace evidence entirely

A young teenager comes to the service seeking advice about ending a pregnancy. Talk through the communication, ethical and legal questions that would guide your response.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Creates a private non-judgemental conversation

Middle

- Explores understanding, voluntary choice and safeguarding concerns
- Seeks suitable clinical support and checks applicable law without inventing age rules

End

- Agrees confidential support and appropriate next steps

Mistakes to avoid

- Automatically informing parents or assuming coercion without exploring it

The spouse of a patient with serious heart disease asks you to convince their partner to take medication. The patient understands that refusing it could shorten their life and still declines. How would you respond to both people?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the spouse's fear and the patient's stated informed choice

Middle

- Explores the patient's reasons without recruiting the spouse to pressure them
- Discusses alternatives and what can be shared with consent

End

- Respects refusal while offering ongoing support to both

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating the spouse's preference as overriding a capacitated adult

A patient shows you an alternative treatment they found online. How would you explore their interest and discuss whether to try it?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Asks what attracts the patient to the alternative treatment

Middle

- Checks evidence, possible harms and interactions with qualified help
- Discusses uncertainty and the risk of delaying effective care

End

- Agrees a respectful informed plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Ridiculing the patient or endorsing a treatment because it is natural

A patient would like an HIV test. Talk through the issues you would address when discussing the test, arranging it and following up the result.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores the patient's concerns and understanding of HIV testing

Middle

- Discusses consent, confidentiality and relevant test limitations with clinical support
- Plans how results and support will be provided

End

- Checks understanding and arranges appropriate follow-up

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising that one result answers every timing or risk question

Someone you are caring for has HIV and tells you they will not disclose this to their sexual partner. What would guide your next steps and your discussion with the patient?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores the reasons for non-disclosure without immediate judgement

Middle

- Encourages supported disclosure and assesses actual risk with senior advice
- Weighs confidentiality and justified protection of others under guidance

End

- Explains proportionate next steps and documents reasoning

Mistakes to avoid

- Automatically contacting the partner without assessment or promising absolute secrecy

Which ethical issues surround the use of animals in medical research?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies potential human benefit alongside animal welfare

Middle

- Discusses replacement, reduction and refinement
- Examines necessity, oversight and alternatives

End

- Gives a balanced conditional judgement

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming any possible medical benefit justifies unlimited animal harm

A family hopes that having another child could help provide treatment for a child they already have. Discuss the ethical considerations for the family and for each child.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Considers the interests of both the existing and future child

Middle

- Explores consent, burden, family expectations and welfare
- Considers alternatives and independent ethical advice

End

- Avoids treating either child only as a means to an end

Mistakes to avoid

- Discussing only parental wishes or the older child's benefit

A senior doctor is about to see patients, but you suspect they have been drinking alcohol. Talk through how you would handle your concern.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises immediate patient-safety implications

Middle

- Reports objective observations promptly to an appropriate senior
- Prevents unsafe practice through proper escalation without public accusations

End

- Supports the colleague and records factual concerns

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring risk because the doctor is senior or diagnosing intoxication from suspicion alone

A colleague wants you to write them a prescription outside the usual consultation process. How would you handle the request and explain your response?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the request bypasses usual safeguards

Middle

- Explains the need for proper assessment and records
- Declines to act outside competence and directs them to appropriate care

End

- Maintains professional boundaries without shaming the colleague

Mistakes to avoid

- Prescribing as a favour or treating friendship as adequate assessment

You discover a colleague using a workplace computer to access material that is illegal or seriously inappropriate. Talk through how you would decide what action to take.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies observed facts and any immediate safeguarding risk

Middle

- Uses appropriate reporting channels and preserves confidentiality
- Avoids conducting an unauthorised investigation or copying material

End

- Documents factual concerns and follows policy

Mistakes to avoid

- Sharing the material with colleagues or ignoring potentially serious harm

Under which circumstances, if any, might withholding the full truth be ethically defensible?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes withholding detail from sensitive communication

Middle

- Explores the patient's preferences and the possible harm of concealment
- Considers exceptional justification with senior advice

End

- Preserves honesty and informed choice

Mistakes to avoid

- Using anticipated distress as a routine reason to conceal truth

A colleague tells you about a mistake they have made and asks you to keep it to yourself. What would you say to them, and what would you do next?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains that patient safety prevents promising secrecy

Middle

- Helps the colleague seek supervision and address immediate harm
- Supports honest reporting and appropriate patient communication

End

- Follows through if the colleague does not act

Mistakes to avoid

- Covering up the error out of loyalty

You recognise that something you did in a patient's care was a mistake. Explain your immediate priorities and how you would follow the matter through.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks and addresses immediate patient harm within their role

Middle

- Seeks senior help and reports the mistake honestly
- Supports appropriate explanation, apology and documentation

End

- Reflects and changes systems or practice to prevent recurrence

Mistakes to avoid

- Hiding the mistake or focusing first on reputation

To what extent should doctors always admit mistakes to patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains why openness about mistakes matters

Middle

- Discusses timely accurate communication and appropriate support
- Distinguishes known facts from unresolved investigation

End

- Links candour with learning and maintained trust

Mistakes to avoid

- Withholding an error solely to avoid a complaint

How would you define the duty of candour?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines candour as openness when care goes wrong

Middle

- Explains acknowledging events, apologising and giving known information
- Includes reporting, support and learning

End

- Distinguishes professional responsibility from avoiding blame

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming an apology replaces investigation and corrective action

After receiving treatment, a patient offers you a gift of substantial value. Explain how you would decide whether to accept it and what you would say to the patient.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the patient's gratitude respectfully

Middle

- Considers value, expectations and conflict of interest
- Checks policy and seeks advice before accepting

End

- Explains a tactful boundary and appropriate recording

Mistakes to avoid

- Accepting a substantial gift simply because it was freely offered

Compare being offered an expensive patient gift with being given a small box of chocolates or a thank-you card. Would the value or nature of the gift change your response?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises value and context change gift-related concerns

Middle

- Compares a token gesture with an expensive personal benefit
- Considers repeated gifts, expectations and policy

End

- Gives a proportionate transparent response

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming every small gift is automatically harmless

To what extent should pharmaceutical companies be allowed to sponsor medical education?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises educational funding may bring benefit and influence

Middle

- Weighs access to education against promotional bias
- Discusses disclosure, independent content and alternatives

End

- Supports safeguards and critical appraisal

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming disclosure alone removes a conflict

Which problems can arise when doctors or researchers have financial conflicts of interest?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how financial interests can influence judgement

Middle

- Discusses selection, interpretation or promotion of evidence
- Considers patient trust and research credibility

End

- Proposes disclosure and independent oversight

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating a conflict as proof of fraud or as harmless by definition

You do not think antibiotics are needed, but the patient asks you to prescribe them. Talk through how you would discuss their request and reach a plan.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores what the patient expects antibiotics to achieve

Middle

- Explains the assessment and likely lack of benefit in plain language
- Discusses harms, alternatives and appropriate safety-netting

End

- Agrees a plan and checks understanding

Mistakes to avoid

- Prescribing solely to end disagreement

A patient is pressing for a scan that you do not believe is clinically indicated. Explain how you would explore their concerns and respond to the request.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Asks what concern lies behind the scan request

Middle

- Explains why a scan may not help and possible downsides
- Discusses alternatives and review if symptoms change

End

- Keeps the patient involved in a safe plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing the request without addressing fear or uncertainty

A relative presses you for details of a patient's care. The patient has expressly refused permission to share them. How would you respond?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the relative's concern without disclosing details

Middle

- Respects the patient's express refusal
- Offers to listen or provide general support without confirming private information

End

- Seeks advice if a serious risk creates a separate justification

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming close relatives have automatic access to records

A student posts about a memorable patient encounter on social media without naming the patient. How would you assess whether the post is appropriate?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises patients can be identifiable without names

Middle

- Checks combinations of details, images, timing and consent
- Considers professional boundaries and the purpose of posting

End

- Removes or escalates a concern appropriately

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming anonymisation means deleting the name only

A doctor uses their professional identity while sharing a controversial political view publicly. Discuss the professional considerations raised by doing so.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Balances freedom of expression with professional responsibilities

Middle

- Considers how professional identity may imply expertise or endorsement
- Discusses respectful conduct, accuracy and public trust

End

- Distinguishes personal views from institutional or medical advice

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming doctors cannot express political views or face no professional implications

How could doctors improve health without directly treating illness?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a route to better health beyond treatment

Middle

- Explains prevention, advocacy or improved access
- Connects action with social or environmental conditions

End

- Recognises the need for partnership beyond medicine

Mistakes to avoid

- Limiting doctors' influence to prescriptions and procedures

How does politics influence healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies how political decisions shape healthcare

Middle

- Explains funding, legislation and priority-setting
- Considers public accountability and competing values

End

- Distinguishes evidence from political judgement

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming healthcare policy is purely technical

To what extent should healthcare decisions ever be separated entirely from politics?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises resource choices carry public values

Middle

- Weighs expert independence against democratic accountability
- Discusses safeguards against short-term interference

End

- Proposes evidence-informed transparent decisions

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming all healthcare decisions can be value-free

How could society decide how much money to spend on healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Frames health spending within competing social needs

Middle

- Weighs population benefit, affordability and opportunity cost
- Includes prevention and non-health spending that affects health

End

- Supports public deliberation and evidence review

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming any increase in health spending is automatically the best use of funds

Which factors shape the way doctors are portrayed by the media?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies incentives and perspectives shaping portrayals

Middle

- Discusses dramatic cases, expert sources and editorial selection
- Contrasts individual stories with wider service evidence

End

- Explains how to read portrayals critically

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating all media as equally accurate or equally hostile

Can media coverage affect public trust in doctors?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains a plausible link between coverage and trust

Middle

- Considers accurate scrutiny alongside sensationalism
- Shows how repeated framing affects expectations

End

- Suggests clear accountable professional communication

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming criticism of doctors is inherently harmful

Which factors cause health inequalities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies interacting causes of unequal health

Middle

- Explains social disadvantage, environment and access
- Recognises discrimination and unequal exposure to risk

End

- Connects causes with targeted action

Mistakes to avoid

- Attributing inequalities only to individual motivation

Should people pay a greater share of the costs associated with their own health? Discuss how you would set limits on personal financial responsibility.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Sets out personal responsibility alongside shared protection

Middle

- Considers ability to pay and control over health risks
- Examines deterrence, stigma and administrative complexity

End

- Justifies limits that preserve essential access

Mistakes to avoid

- Charging according to moral blame for illness

What would you say are complementary and alternative therapies?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes complementary use alongside care from alternative replacement

Middle

- Recognises therapies differ in evidence and risk
- Explains why each claim needs appraisal

End

- Keeps discussion respectful and evidence-aware

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all complementary therapies are either effective or harmless

The evidence supporting a complementary therapy is limited. How would you assess whether the NHS should pay for patients to receive it?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises limited evidence as a funding uncertainty

Middle

- Assesses plausible benefit, harm, cost and alternatives
- Considers research or monitored evaluation rather than automatic adoption

End

- Justifies a proportionate funding view

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating popularity or testimonials with effectiveness

How could evidence be used when deciding whether a treatment should be offered?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how evidence informs treatment benefits and risks

Middle

- Considers study quality and applicability
- Combines evidence with clinical judgement and patient preferences

End

- Recognises uncertainty and the need to update decisions

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating one favourable paper as sufficient proof

You are researching a topic you know little about and encounter several sources. How would you decide which information deserves your trust?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks authorship, purpose and original evidence

Middle

- Compares methods and corroboration across reliable sources
- Looks for currency, conflicts and unsupported certainty

End

- States what remains uncertain before trusting a claim

Mistakes to avoid

- Trusting a source solely because it looks professional

How could you identify gaps in your own knowledge?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises uncertainty as a starting point for learning

Middle

- Uses questions, feedback and mistakes to expose gaps
- Compares understanding with learning objectives or reliable guidance

End

- Creates and reviews a targeted learning plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Confusing familiarity with mastery

To what extent is medicine primarily a science, an art, or a combination of both?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Defines scientific and human aspects of medicine

Middle

- Explains evidence and analytical reasoning
- Shows how judgement and communication adapt care to individuals

End

- Integrates both without dismissing either

Mistakes to avoid

- Using the art of medicine to excuse ignoring evidence

Which approaches could increase the supply of organs for transplantation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies several ways to improve donation and transplantation

Middle

- Discusses informed public engagement and service capacity
- Considers donor identification, family discussions and ethical safeguards

End

- Recognises more organs alone require effective matching and delivery

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming changing consent rules alone solves organ shortages

How could society encourage organ donation while respecting individual choice?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Balances encouraging donation with voluntary choice

Middle

- Explains accessible information and respectful discussion
- Addresses trust, cultural concerns and recording wishes

End

- Avoids pressure while making participation easier

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating reluctance to donate as selfishness

Discuss how views about doctors' clothing and appearance have developed over time. What might explain changes in expectations of professional dress?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains that professional dress expectations reflect context

Middle

- Considers infection control, identification and social change
- Includes patient confidence and cultural inclusion

End

- Prioritises safe respectful practice over arbitrary appearance

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating a particular style or background with competence

Which factors influence differences in life expectancy across the UK?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises geographic life-expectancy differences have multiple causes

Middle

- Explores deprivation, employment, housing and service access
- Distinguishes population averages from individual destiny

End

- Identifies useful local evidence before proposing action

Mistakes to avoid

- Using regional stereotypes as explanations

Why do you think doctors can rarely guarantee that a treatment will be successful?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains that treatment outcomes involve uncertainty

Middle

- Discusses individual variation, illness complexity and imperfect evidence
- Distinguishes probabilities from guarantees

End

- Supports honest shared decision-making

Mistakes to avoid

- Interpreting failure as proof the treatment never works

Consider the route through medical training for someone with a significant disability. Where might they encounter barriers, and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies barriers along entry, study and placements

Middle

- Discusses inaccessible environments and assumptions about ability
- Distinguishes essential competencies from avoidable obstacles

End

- Supports individual assessment and reasonable adjustments

Mistakes to avoid

- Inferring inability to practise from a disability label

How could medical schools support students with disabilities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Starts with the student's own needs and preferences

Middle

- Discusses accessible learning, placements and assessment
- Includes confidential support and staff preparation

End

- Reviews whether adjustments enable fair participation

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering identical support to every disabled student

Which role should charities play in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies useful charitable roles in support, research or advocacy

Middle

- Explains flexibility and community reach
- Considers accountability and limits of voluntary funding

End

- Positions charities within coordinated care

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming charity can replace all public responsibility

Imagine that essential local health services depend heavily on charitable support. What difficulties could that dependence create?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises essential services need reliable equitable funding

Middle

- Explains donation volatility and unequal fundraising capacity
- Considers donor influence and service continuity

End

- Proposes sustainable oversight and contingency planning

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming popular causes reflect greatest health need

What do you see as the benefits of openly acknowledging mistakes?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how acknowledging mistakes enables action

Middle

- Connects openness with correcting harm and preserving trust
- Discusses learning across teams

End

- Includes follow-through and system improvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating admission alone as sufficient learning

Which disadvantages or difficulties can arise from admitting mistakes?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges emotional and professional difficulty in admitting error

Middle

- Discusses fear, uncertainty and potential complaints
- Explains support and careful factual communication

End

- Maintains openness despite discomfort

Mistakes to avoid

- Using possible consequences to justify concealment

To what extent is it appropriate for healthcare professionals to accept gifts from patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Examines gifts in their professional context

Middle

- Considers value, expectations and patient vulnerability
- Discusses local policy, advice and transparency

End

- Gives a proportionate boundary

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming good intentions eliminate conflicts of interest

Consider a high-risk sport such as boxing. What part, if any, should doctors play in setting or enforcing the rules around participation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises participant autonomy and preventable harm

Middle

- Discusses doctors' role in evidence, safety standards and assessment
- Considers independence from commercial pressures

End

- Balances risk reduction with informed participation

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating medical presence as proof a sport is risk-free

To what extent should doctors be expected to set an example through their own lifestyle?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Considers role-modelling without demanding flawless private lives

Middle

- Distinguishes personal choices from conduct affecting safe practice
- Acknowledges stigma and realistic wellbeing

End

- Supports credible respectful advice regardless of appearance

Mistakes to avoid

- Judging professional ability by body shape or lifestyle stereotypes

Why does representation within the medical workforce matter? Discuss the value of diversity in a profession that has not always offered equal representation.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Connects representation with fair opportunity and varied perspectives

Middle

- Explains potential benefits for trust, access and decision-making
- Recognises inclusion requires removing barriers

End

- Avoids assuming identity alone determines insight

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating diversity as lowering professional standards

A service is considering giving nurses and other healthcare professionals a wider range of responsibilities. What benefits and difficulties would you want it to examine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies potential access and skill-mix benefits

Middle

- Examines training, scope, supervision and role clarity
- Considers workload and patient understanding

End

- Supports evaluated expansion with clear accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming wider roles are either universally safe or inherently unsafe

How could medical training adapt as technology and healthcare become more complex?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies skills needed for increasing complexity

Middle

- Discusses evidence appraisal, digital literacy and teamwork
- Protects core clinical reasoning and communication

End

- Supports ongoing adaptable training

Mistakes to avoid

- Replacing foundational understanding with learning to operate tools only

How could doctors maintain motivation throughout a long career?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises motivation changes over a long career

Middle

- Discusses meaningful work, development and supportive relationships
- Considers workload and organisational conditions

End

- Uses reflection and adjustment rather than constant self-pressure

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming loss of motivation solely on an individual's attitude

Design one question you would use to Med interview a medical-school applicant. Explain what you would hope to learn from their answer.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Proposes one clear applicant-appropriate question

Middle

- Explains the quality or reasoning it would assess
- Describes useful evidence and how to avoid rewarding privilege or rehearsal

End

- Recognises the limits of one answer

Mistakes to avoid

- Designing a trick question with an arbitrary correct response

To what extent should doctors ever strike?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Acknowledges employment rights and patient duties

Middle

- Weighs immediate disruption against workforce and service concerns
- Discusses negotiation, safeguards and emergency cover

End

- Offers a reasoned position without assuming one political answer

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring either patient risk or legitimate staff concerns

Doctors have obligations to their patients as well as employment rights. How would you approach a situation in which these pull in different directions?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the specific tension between duties and employment rights

Middle

- Considers options that protect patients while raising concerns
- Uses proportionate escalation and collective processes

End

- Explains a defensible balance and practical safeguards

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming either duty always erases the other

When saving life and improving quality of life lead to different healthcare priorities, how should the competing goals be weighed?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises survival and quality of life are both meaningful

Middle

- Considers patient preferences, likely benefit and burden
- Examines opportunity costs and unequal assumptions

End

- Supports individualised transparent prioritisation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming longer life is always the patient's only goal

Consider a proposal to move part of the NHS treatment budget into prevention. What would determine whether that change was justified?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the proposed prevention benefit and treatment cost

Middle

- Examines evidence, time to benefit and distribution of gains
- Considers transition risks for people needing care now

End

- Justifies a measured shift with evaluation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all prevention immediately saves money

How should society decide what it can spend on treatments that extend life? Discuss whether any spending limit can be justified.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises finite resources and the value of life extension

Middle

- Considers magnitude of benefit, quality of life and alternatives
- Examines fairness and exceptional circumstances

End

- Supports transparent revisable limits

Mistakes to avoid

- Assigning worth to people by income or social status

A patient's preferred option may compete with the wider population's healthcare needs. How should the NHS weigh individual choice against those needs?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Acknowledges patient preference alongside population obligations

Middle

- Assesses benefit, alternatives and resource consequences
- Explains fair criteria and honest communication

End

- Offers a justified plan without dismissing the individual

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating either personal choice or population totals as automatically decisive

To what extent should healthcare be treated as a right?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains what a right to healthcare could mean

Middle

- Weighs dignity and fair access against finite resources
- Distinguishes essential access from unlimited entitlement

End

- Defines a defensible scope and shared responsibilities

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming calling healthcare a right removes scarcity

Why do you think medical research is important?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how research addresses uncertainty in medicine

Middle

- Connects research with prevention, diagnosis or treatment improvement
- Recognises ethical methods and useful negative findings

End

- Links discovery with careful application

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming research benefits patients automatically

You can establish a new medical research institute with substantial funding. Set out the research area you would focus on and explain why it deserves that investment.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses a defined research area and unmet need

Middle

- Explains potential benefit and feasible research questions
- Considers neglected groups, ethics and competing priorities

End

- Identifies how success and value would be assessed

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising a cure merely because funding is substantial

Choose a medical discovery from approximately the past hundred years that you consider especially influential. Make the case for its impact compared with other discoveries.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Selects a discovery within the requested approximate period

Middle

- Explains its effect on outcomes or medical practice
- Compares its reach and limitations with another advance

End

- Justifies influence without claiming an objective universal winner

Mistakes to avoid

- Confusing an ancient discovery with a recent development

Which area of medical research interests you most?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names a specific research interest and personal reason

Middle

- Explains a question researchers are trying to answer
- Discusses potential value and uncertainty

End

- Identifies what they would like to learn next

Mistakes to avoid

- Using technical terms without understanding the research question

Select a public-health advance from the modern era that you regard as particularly important. Explain what makes its contribution stand out.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses a modern public-health advance

Middle

- Explains its mechanism and population impact
- Considers accessibility and implementation rather than discovery alone

End

- Justifies why its contribution stands out

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing advances without making a comparative case

How would you define evidence-based medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines evidence-based medicine as integrating evidence, expertise and patient values

Middle

- Explains critical appraisal and applicability
- Recognises uncertainty and changing knowledge

End

- Applies evidence to the individual context

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating evidence-based practice with blindly following a paper

Why do you think randomised controlled trials are useful?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains random allocation and a comparator

Middle

- Shows how randomisation can reduce confounding
- Discusses fair outcome measurement and appropriate analysis

End

- Recognises randomisation improves inference without guaranteeing quality

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming trials eliminate every bias

What do you see as some limitations of clinical trials?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a concrete limitation of clinical trials

Middle

- Discusses selected participants, duration or practical constraints
- Explains how this affects applicability or detection of harm

End

- Considers complementary evidence

Mistakes to avoid

- Rejecting all trial evidence because trials have limitations

Why do you think correlation does not necessarily mean causation?

General

- Clearly distinguishes correlation from causation
- Uses logical scientific reasoning
- Uses a relevant simple example
- Recognises alternative explanations

Start

- Defines correlation clearly
- States that an association does not automatically prove cause

Middle

- Explains that another factor may affect both variables
- Recognises the relationship could work in the opposite direction
- Uses an example to demonstrate the problem
- Explains why further evidence would be needed

End

- Recognises correlation can still be useful
- States that stronger evidence is required before claiming causation

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying correlation is useless
- Saying strong correlation automatically proves causation
- Giving an example without explaining it
- Confusing association with proof

Why do you think peer review is important?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains peer review as expert scrutiny before publication

Middle

- Discusses checking methods, interpretation and reporting
- Recognises reviewers can miss errors or share biases

End

- Uses peer review as one quality indicator

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating publication as a guarantee of truth

How might you decide whether a health claim you saw on social media was trustworthy?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Traces the social-media claim to its original evidence

Middle

- Checks study design, relevance and conflicts
- Compares the headline with actual outcomes and uncertainty

End

- Withholds firm judgement if evidence is insufficient

Mistakes to avoid

- Trusting follower counts or a professional-looking profile alone

Why do you think two scientific studies might reach different conclusions?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises disagreement may have methodological explanations

Middle

- Compares populations, interventions, outcomes and timing
- Considers chance, bias and analytical choices

End

- Looks across the evidence rather than choosing the preferred result

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming one conflicting study must be dishonest

How would you define the purpose of medical research ethics?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines research ethics around participants' rights and welfare

Middle

- Explains consent, proportional risk and fair selection
- Includes independent oversight and scientific value

End

- Balances knowledge generation with participant protection

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming valuable research excuses any method

Why do you think informed consent is important in research?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains voluntary informed participation

Middle

- Distinguishes research from guaranteed personalised benefit
- Discusses understandable risks, alternatives and withdrawal

End

- Treats consent as continuing communication

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating a signature with understanding or implying refusal affects usual care

To what extent is it acceptable to conduct research involving patients who lack capacity?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises inclusion and protection both matter

Middle

- Considers necessity, proportionate risk and applicable safeguards
- Seeks appropriate ethical and legal processes without assuming ordinary consent

End

- Respects participation, dissent and welfare

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming incapacity either permits unrestricted research or requires automatic exclusion

Which ethical issues arise when testing new treatments?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies uncertainty when testing a new treatment

Middle

- Weighs potential benefit against harm and fair recruitment
- Discusses consent, comparison groups and independent monitoring

End

- Includes stopping or changing a study when justified

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting experimental treatment as a proven cure

Why do you think representation of different populations is important in clinical research?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains why study populations affect applicability

Middle

- Considers differences in response, access and baseline risk
- Discusses inclusive recruitment without stereotyping

End

- Links representation with fair evidence and benefit

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming results from one narrow group apply equally to everyone

How would you explain the difference between statistical significance and clinical significance?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes statistical evidence from meaningful patient benefit

Middle

- Explains effect size and uncertainty
- Uses an example of a small detectable effect or an imprecise important effect

End

- Considers both clinical relevance and study precision

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating a low p-value with a large or useful benefit

Why do you think treatments sometimes appear promising in early research but fail later?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises early promising results need confirmation

Middle

- Explains small samples, selected populations and chance
- Considers longer-term safety and real-world complexity

End

- Values replication and staged evaluation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming later failure necessarily means fraud

How could doctors communicate uncertainty in scientific evidence to patients?

General

- Clear and understandable communication
- Honest about uncertainty
- Adapts language to the patient
- Checks understanding throughout

Start

- Explains clearly that some uncertainty exists
- Establishes what the patient already understands

Middle

- Uses simple language rather than jargon
- Explains what is known and what remains uncertain
- Acknowledges the patient’s concerns
- Checks understanding and encourages questions

End

- Summarises the key information
- Checks understanding again
- Explains appropriate next steps

Mistakes to avoid

- Pretending the evidence is completely certain
- Using excessive jargon
- Overloading the patient with unexplained information
- Failing to check understanding

Consider weight-management injections such as semaglutide and tirzepatide. How would you weigh the opportunities they offer against the challenges of using them in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Introduces weight-management medicines as one part of care

Middle

- Weighs potential health benefit against adverse effects, cost and ongoing support
- Distinguishes products and indications without inventing eligibility rules

End

- Supports evidence-informed individual assessment

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating medicines as a universal solution or giving prescribing advice

To what extent should medications for obesity be widely available through the NHS?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises potential need alongside finite NHS resources

Middle

- Considers effectiveness, cost and equitable access
- Includes long-term support and opportunity cost

End

- Gives a conditional view on expansion

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all patients with obesity have identical needs or suitability

If NHS access to expensive weight-management medicines is limited, what should determine which patients are offered them first?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Proposes clinically relevant criteria for limited access

Middle

- Considers severity, likely benefit and unmet need
- Explains transparent selection and review

End

- Avoids stigma and unjustified social ranking

Mistakes to avoid

- Prioritising solely by ability to pay or perceived willpower

Discuss how individual choices, medical factors and wider social conditions contribute to obesity. How should these perspectives shape where responsibility is placed?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises obesity has biological, behavioural and social influences

Middle

- Explains interactions between environment and individual choices
- Considers access to food, activity and medical support

End

- Shares responsibility without removing individual agency

Mistakes to avoid

- Reducing obesity to laziness or one cause

Imagine weight-loss medication becoming widely used. What effects might this have on public attitudes towards obesity?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Identifies ways widespread medication use could change attitudes

Middle

- Considers reduced blame through recognition of biology
- Discusses new appearance pressures or stigma around treatment

End

- Supports nuanced respectful public communication

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming medication use will automatically eliminate stigma

Compare the ethical considerations involved when prescription weight-loss medicines are obtained privately rather than through public healthcare. Which concerns would you examine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Frames private access around choice and equity

Middle

- Discusses affordability, continuity and appropriate oversight
- Considers pressure, marketing and resource implications

End

- Supports consistent clinical safeguards across funding routes

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming private payment proves a prescription is appropriate

A patient asks for a prescription weight-loss medicine chiefly to change their appearance. How would you explore the request and discuss your response?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explores the patient's goals and expectations without judgement

Middle

- Considers wellbeing, suitability and possible pressure about appearance
- Explains benefits, harms and alternatives through proper assessment

End

- Maintains prescribing boundaries and supportive care

Mistakes to avoid

- Prescribing on demand or dismissing appearance-related distress

Which responsibilities do social-media influencers have when discussing prescription medicines?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises an influencer's reach can affect medical decisions

Middle

- Discusses accuracy, conflicts and limits of personal experience
- Distinguishes education from promotion and personalised advice

End

- Supports transparency and referral to qualified advice

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting a personal success story as universal evidence

What would determine whether spending on weight-loss medication leads to lower NHS costs over the longer term?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Distinguishes treatment expenditure from downstream savings

Middle

- Considers sustained benefit, duration, adverse effects and service costs
- Examines uptake and the time horizon of avoided illness

End

- Requests economic evidence rather than assuming savings

Mistakes to avoid

- Counting benefits while omitting ongoing medication and support costs

A medicine attracts intense publicity and demand, while public understanding of its benefits and side effects remains limited. What problems could follow from this mismatch?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a gap between publicity and informed understanding

Middle

- Explains unrealistic expectations, unsafe sourcing or pressure on services
- Considers shortages and misinformation about adverse effects

End

- Suggests clear evidence-based communication and appropriate access

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming high demand demonstrates medical value

What do you see as the most important lessons healthcare systems should learn from the COVID-19 pandemic?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Selects concrete system lessons from the pandemic

Middle

- Discusses preparedness, workforce protection or communication
- Considers unequal impact and continuity of other care

End

- Links lessons to changes that can be evaluated

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating the pandemic as having one simple lesson

How could the UK prepare for a future pandemic?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Sets out preparation before an outbreak begins

Middle

- Includes surveillance, workforce capacity and supply resilience
- Discusses clear communication and international coordination

End

- Uses exercises and review to test readiness

Mistakes to avoid

- Focusing only on stockpiles without people or delivery systems

During a period without a major outbreak, a government must decide how much to invest in pandemic preparedness. How would you assess the case for substantial ongoing funding?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises preparedness has value even when unused

Middle

- Weighs uncertain major harm against ongoing costs
- Considers flexible capacity useful between emergencies

End

- Justifies proportionate sustained investment with review

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling unused preparedness wasted spending by definition

Which ethical issues arise when governments restrict individual freedoms during a public-health emergency?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies liberty, collective safety and unequal burdens

Middle

- Examines necessity, proportionality and less restrictive alternatives
- Includes transparency, time limits and support for affected people

End

- Reviews restrictions as evidence changes

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating an emergency as unlimited authority

How could healthcare systems prioritise patients when resources become extremely limited?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises severe scarcity needs consistent fair processes

Middle

- Considers urgency and likely benefit with specialist guidance
- Rejects social worth and unsupported group assumptions

End

- Includes communication, reassessment and support for all patients

Mistakes to avoid

- Making arbitrary bedside exclusions based on stereotypes

In what ways did COVID-19 affect trust in healthcare and science?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges trust changed differently across communities

Middle

- Considers scientific progress and effective care alongside inconsistent messaging
- Discusses misinformation, inequality and changing evidence

End

- Identifies ways to earn trust through openness

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming the public had one uniform response

Why do you think misinformation became such a major challenge during the pandemic?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains why uncertainty created demand for rapid explanations

Middle

- Discusses emotional stories, information overload and platform incentives
- Distinguishes evolving evidence from deliberate deception

End

- Supports accessible timely correction

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling everyone who shared misinformation unintelligent

How could doctors respond to vaccine misinformation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Finds out which vaccine claim concerns the person

Middle

- Checks the claim against reliable evidence
- Responds respectfully with clear risk explanations

End

- Invites questions and keeps dialogue open

Mistakes to avoid

- Overwhelming the person with facts before hearing their concern

Which challenges does long COVID create for patients and healthcare systems?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises persistent symptoms can affect daily life and work

Middle

- Discusses uncertain needs, access and multidisciplinary support
- Considers service capacity and research gaps

End

- Supports individualised care without false certainty

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing symptoms because a single explanation is unavailable

Patients with long COVID may describe different combinations of complex symptoms. How would you approach care when experiences vary substantially from one person to another?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Listens to the individual's symptoms and priorities

Middle

- Avoids assuming a uniform long-COVID experience
- Considers appropriate assessment, coordinated support and uncertainty

End

- Agrees reviewable goals with the patient

Mistakes to avoid

- Using a one-size-fits-all care plan or inventing a cure

Compare a COVID vaccination programme focused on people at greatest risk with one routinely offered to everyone. What should determine the choice between these approaches?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Defines the aims of a targeted versus universal programme

Middle

- Compares expected benefit, risk, delivery costs and access
- Considers changing disease patterns and evidence

End

- Supports a periodically reviewed decision

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting current eligibility as permanent or assuming one approach always wins

A public-health emergency is developing and the evidence keeps changing. How could a government explain what remains uncertain while maintaining public trust?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Separates established findings from unresolved questions

Middle

- Explains why advice may change and what would trigger revision
- Uses consistent accessible messages and acknowledges mistakes

End

- Commits to updates and public engagement

Mistakes to avoid

- Hiding uncertainty to project confidence

Which opportunities could artificial intelligence create in medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses a concrete potential use of medical AI

Middle

- Explains how it could improve workflow, analysis or access
- Considers validation, bias and implementation costs

End

- Supports evaluated use with human accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing futuristic capabilities as proven benefits

Which risks could arise from using AI to support diagnosis?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a diagnostic risk specific to AI

Middle

- Discusses unrepresentative data, false outputs or automation bias
- Explains validation and monitoring in the intended setting

End

- Keeps clinical assessment and escalation available

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming high average accuracy guarantees safety for every patient

An AI system recommends a clinical course of action. How much weight should a doctor give that recommendation when making their decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Treats the AI output as evidence requiring judgement

Middle

- Checks relevance, reliability and consistency with the patient's situation
- Investigates disagreement and seeks appropriate expertise

End

- Takes responsibility for a justified clinical decision

Mistakes to avoid

- Automatically following or rejecting every AI recommendation

A patient is harmed by a medical decision in which an AI system played a part. How would you think through who should be held responsible?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Starts with patient support and establishing what happened

Middle

- Examines clinician, organisation and developer contributions
- Distinguishes accountability from unsupported assignment of blame

End

- Supports investigation and preventive change

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming the algorithm as if no human or organisation is accountable

Could AI take over the role of a doctor? Discuss which parts of the role might be replaceable and where the limits could lie.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Separates individual tasks from the full doctor's role

Middle

- Discusses automation of bounded work
- Considers relationships, uncertainty, physical care and accountability

End

- Offers a cautious task-specific conclusion

Mistakes to avoid

- Predicting complete replacement with certainty

What aspects of medicine are least likely to be replaced by artificial intelligence?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a human responsibility that is difficult to automate

Middle

- Explains trust, contextual judgement or navigating values
- Recognises tools may still assist that work

End

- Avoids absolute predictions about future technology

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming empathy is merely a set of scripted phrases

Where might AI help people access healthcare sooner, and how could it affect waiting times?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a specific access bottleneck AI might reduce

Middle

- Explains triage, scheduling or administrative support
- Considers downstream capacity and new demand

End

- Measures actual waiting time and equity after introduction

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming faster analysis alone creates more treatment capacity

How might introducing AI into healthcare widen health inequalities that already exist?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a mechanism by which AI could widen a gap

Middle

- Discusses data under-representation and unequal digital access
- Considers uneven deployment across services

End

- Proposes subgroup evaluation and accessible alternatives

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming equal software availability means equal benefit

Which risks arise from bias in healthcare algorithms?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains algorithmic bias through unequal errors or outcomes

Middle

- Connects training data and measurement choices with harm
- Discusses testing and monitoring across relevant populations

End

- Requires accountability and correction when disparities appear

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming removing protected labels removes every source of bias

How could patient data be protected when it is used to train medical AI systems?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises health data require controlled legitimate use

Middle

- Discusses minimisation, secure access and appropriate governance
- Considers re-identification and secondary use

End

- Includes transparency and ongoing oversight

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling anonymisation an absolute guarantee of privacy

Discuss what patients should be told when AI helps shape their diagnosis or treatment. Should disclosure be required in every case?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Considers what information matters to a patient's decision

Middle

- Explains the AI's role, limitations and human responsibility
- Distinguishes material clinical influence from incidental administration

End

- Supports proportionate understandable transparency

Mistakes to avoid

- Either concealing meaningful AI involvement or overwhelming patients with technical detail

If AI reduces the time doctors spend on administration, how might that affect their communication with patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how reduced administration might release consultation time

Middle

- Considers whether time is used for listening or increased throughput
- Discusses accurate records and effects on interaction

End

- Evaluates patient experience rather than assuming improvement

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating time saved with empathy gained automatically

Consider a clinical team that becomes heavily dependent on AI tools. What effects could that reliance have on doctors' own clinical skills?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises dependence can affect skill maintenance

Middle

- Discusses reduced practice, automation bias and loss of independent checking
- Includes training and plans for tool failure

End

- Balances useful assistance with preserved competence

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming clinicians will retain skills they never exercise

How could medical education change because of artificial intelligence?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies educational skills needed for AI-supported care

Middle

- Discusses appraisal, bias and responsible use
- Preserves reasoning, communication and supervised practice

End

- Proposes assessment of both tool use and independent understanding

Mistakes to avoid

- Replacing core medical learning with prompting alone

Why do waiting times matter for patients and for healthcare services?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains consequences of delay for patients

Middle

- Considers deterioration, anxiety and effects on work or family
- Connects delays with service pressure and complexity

End

- Recognises waiting-time measures need context

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating waiting times as only an administrative target

How could patients on a waiting list be prioritised?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Uses need and deterioration risk to guide waiting-list order

Middle

- Considers time already waited, impact and changing symptoms
- Explains fair review and accessible communication

End

- Provides a route to reassessment

Mistakes to avoid

- Prioritising those who complain most loudly

When deciding the order in which patients on a waiting list are seen, should clinical urgency outweigh every other consideration? Explain your reasoning.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises urgency is central but needs careful definition

Middle

- Weighs immediate risk alongside prolonged suffering and deterioration
- Considers fairness among similar levels of need

End

- Explains a transparent process that can respond to change

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring cumulative harm from long waits

What steps could the NHS take to reduce waiting times without compromising quality?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies causes of delays before proposing solutions

Middle

- Considers staffing, diagnostics, discharge and scheduling
- Explains quality safeguards and sustainable workload

End

- Measures both waiting time and care outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Meeting targets by rushing care or moving queues elsewhere

An NHS patient cannot be treated within an acceptable timeframe. Discuss whether arranging their treatment in the private sector is an appropriate response.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Weighs timely care against the implications of outsourcing

Middle

- Considers quality, continuity, cost and workforce availability
- Protects equitable access and information transfer

End

- Gives a conditional view with accountable contracts

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming private-sector treatment is automatically better or worse

In what ways could technology meaningfully reduce NHS waiting lists?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Selects a technology addressing a defined queue problem

Middle

- Explains referrals, reminders or scheduling improvements
- Considers implementation burden and digital exclusion

End

- Checks whether overall waits fall without compromising care

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating technology as a substitute for necessary staff or beds

Which role should prevention play in reducing long-term pressure on NHS services?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how prevention may reduce future illness and demand

Middle

- Considers targeted interventions and wider social conditions
- Acknowledges time to benefit and current treatment needs

End

- Balances investment across short and long horizons

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming every preventive programme saves money immediately

How could the NHS balance increasing demand against limited staff and funding?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises demand, workforce and funding are linked

Middle

- Combines fair prioritisation with retention and pathway improvement
- Considers prevention and realistic productivity limits

End

- Explains trade-offs transparently

Mistakes to avoid

- Expecting existing staff to absorb unlimited additional work

What do you see as the potential benefits of introducing new professional roles into healthcare teams?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies benefits from a broader healthcare skill mix

Middle

- Discusses access, complementary expertise and continuity
- Recognises training and supervision needs

End

- Supports evaluation of patient outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating new roles solely as cheaper substitutes

Which concerns can arise when the responsibilities of different healthcare professionals overlap?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies ambiguity when responsibilities overlap

Middle

- Explains gaps, duplication and unclear accountability
- Considers communication and competence boundaries

End

- Clarifies ownership and escalation routes

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming overlapping skills mean identical authority

Why do you think clarity about professional roles is important for patient safety?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how knowing roles supports safe decisions

Middle

- Connects task allocation with competence and supervision
- Discusses patients' understanding of who is caring for them

End

- Uses clear introductions and handovers

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating job-title clarity as a purely cosmetic issue

How should patients be told whether they are seeing a doctor, physician associate or another professional? Should this always be made explicit?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Supports clear honest professional introductions

Middle

- Explains title, role and supervision in plain language
- Checks understanding without disparaging other professions

End

- Maintains transparency throughout care

Mistakes to avoid

- Using ambiguous titles that lead patients to assume someone is a doctor

How would you describe good supervision within a healthcare team?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines supervision matched to competence and task risk

Middle

- Explains availability, clear limits and escalation
- Includes feedback and progressive development

End

- Checks both patient safety and the learner's support

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating supervision with a name on a rota who cannot be contacted

You are concerned that a healthcare professional is taking on work beyond their competence. How should a doctor address the concern?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Prioritises any immediate patient risk

Middle

- Clarifies observed actions and competence concerns factually
- Raises the issue respectfully through appropriate supervision

End

- Ensures action is taken and recorded

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring risk to avoid conflict or making unsupported accusations

How could multidisciplinary teams expand access to healthcare while maintaining patient safety?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how complementary roles can increase access

Middle

- Matches tasks with training and clear responsibility
- Includes supervision, handovers and patient communication

End

- Evaluates access alongside safety and continuity

Mistakes to avoid

- Expanding capacity without considering supervisory workload

Why do you think vaccine-preventable diseases sometimes return even when effective vaccines are available?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises vaccine availability does not ensure coverage

Middle

- Discusses access barriers, falling uptake and population movement
- Considers clusters of susceptibility and service disruption

End

- Supports targeted evidence-based responses

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming resurgence entirely on individual hesitancy

Which factors contribute to vaccine hesitancy?

General

- Recognises there can be several contributing factors
- Uses respectful and non-judgemental language
- Shows balanced discussion
- Avoids dismissing people’s concerns

Start

- Recognises vaccine hesitancy is complex
- Avoids assuming everyone has the same reason

Middle

- Considers concerns about safety or information
- Considers trust in healthcare and institutions
- Considers social or cultural influences
- Recognises personal or practical factors may affect decisions

End

- Recognises different concerns require different approaches
- Supports respectful and evidence-based communication
- Emphasises listening as well as providing information

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling hesitant people ignorant
- Treating everyone as having the same concern
- Immediately dismissing questions
- Turning the answer into an argument rather than discussion

How could a doctor speak with a parent who is worried about vaccinating their child?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Invites the parent's specific concerns without judgement

Middle

- Acknowledges emotions and explains benefits and risks clearly
- Checks reliable information and avoids false guarantees

End

- Checks understanding and offers continued discussion

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing the parent or overwhelming them with statistics

To what extent should vaccination ever be compulsory?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Sets out collective protection and individual choice

Middle

- Examines necessity, proportionality and alternatives
- Considers trust, exemptions and unequal burdens

End

- Offers a conditional ethical view with review

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming compulsion is always justified whenever a vaccine works

How could public-health authorities respond to falling vaccination uptake?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Investigates why uptake is falling locally

Middle

- Separates access problems from concerns about vaccination
- Combines accessible delivery with trusted engagement

End

- Monitors coverage and inequality after changes

Mistakes to avoid

- Launching a generic information campaign without checking barriers

Which responsibilities do social-media platforms have regarding medical misinformation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises platforms shape the reach of health claims

Middle

- Considers moderation, transparency and authoritative information
- Weighs harmful misinformation against legitimate debate and error correction

End

- Supports accountable proportionate policies

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating every uncertain or dissenting statement as misinformation

Why do you think false health information can spread more quickly than accurate information?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies features making false claims shareable

Middle

- Explains emotional simplicity, novelty and repeated exposure
- Considers algorithms and low trust in institutions

End

- Suggests accurate communication that is accessible and timely

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming factual detail alone guarantees a correction will spread

How could doctors challenge misinformation without damaging trust?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Starts by understanding why the person trusts the claim

Middle

- Acknowledges concerns and corrects the specific claim clearly
- Avoids ridicule and explains the quality of evidence

End

- Keeps the relationship open for further discussion

Mistakes to avoid

- Turning correction into a contest to embarrass the person

An influencer or celebrity spreads an inaccurate medical claim. When should a healthcare professional challenge it publicly, and what should guide their approach?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Assesses the reach and potential harm of the inaccurate claim

Middle

- Checks evidence before a factual proportionate response
- Avoids amplifying the claim unnecessarily or attacking the person

End

- Provides useful reliable information and corrects their own errors

Mistakes to avoid

- Publicly challenging a claim without verifying it

Why do you think antimicrobial resistance is a major healthcare concern?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains resistance as microbes becoming less susceptible to treatment

Middle

- Connects it with harder-to-treat infections and risks to wider care
- Considers prevention, stewardship and innovation

End

- Recognises coordinated action is needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying patients' bodies become resistant to antibiotics

Explain the link between unnecessary antibiotic prescribing and antimicrobial resistance.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains that antibiotic exposure can select resistant bacteria

Middle

- Connects unnecessary use with avoidable selection pressure
- Recognises appropriate antibiotics remain valuable

End

- Supports evidence-based prescribing and prevention

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming any antibiotic use is always wrong

You think a patient's illness is probably caused by a virus, but they are insistent that they need antibiotics. How would you handle the consultation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores what the patient hopes antibiotics will achieve

Middle

- Explains likely viral illness and why antibiotics may not help
- Offers appropriate symptom support and review advice within the clinical role

End

- Checks understanding and agrees a plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Prescribing solely under pressure or dismissing worsening symptoms

A doctor considers prescribing antibiotics mainly to avoid upsetting a patient. How would you assess the justification for that decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises avoiding conflict is insufficient clinical justification

Middle

- Weighs lack of benefit against adverse effects and resistance
- Considers better explanation and shared planning

End

- Supports a respectful clinically justified decision

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating patient satisfaction as the only outcome

Which responsibilities do patients have in reducing antimicrobial resistance?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies realistic patient actions within wider shared responsibility

Middle

- Discusses using medicines as prescribed and not sharing leftovers
- Includes infection prevention and seeking appropriate advice

End

- Avoids placing the whole burden on patients

Mistakes to avoid

- Advising people to alter prescribed treatment independently

Why do you think antimicrobial resistance requires international cooperation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how resistant organisms and practices cross borders

Middle

- Discusses travel, trade and unequal access to surveillance or treatment
- Considers coordinated stewardship and research

End

- Supports equitable international participation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming one country can solve resistance in isolation

Consider a proposal to give pharmaceutical companies stronger incentives to develop new antibiotics. What would guide your view on whether the proposal is justified?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises a tension between innovation incentives and restrained use

Middle

- Considers funding models, access and public value
- Examines safeguards against encouraging unnecessary sales

End

- Supports accountable incentives tied to useful research

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming greater sales volume is the best reward for new antibiotics

How might agriculture and animal health contribute to antimicrobial resistance?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Connects human, animal and environmental health

Middle

- Explains antimicrobial use and spread through connected systems
- Considers welfare, stewardship and monitoring

End

- Supports coordinated One Health action

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming agriculture alone or ignoring necessary veterinary treatment

To what extent should governments restrict vaping more heavily?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Frames vaping regulation around benefit, harm and autonomy

Middle

- Considers youth uptake alongside adult smoking cessation
- Weighs enforcement and unintended markets

End

- Supports evidence-responsive proportionate restrictions

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating vaping as harmless or identical to smoking in every respect

Vaping policy must consider both its possible use in helping people stop smoking and concerns about young people taking it up. How would you weigh those two considerations?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises adult cessation and youth prevention as distinct aims

Middle

- Compares targeted access and marketing restrictions
- Considers substitution, uptake and uncertainty

End

- Proposes evaluating both smoking and vaping outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring one population when judging policy

To what extent should flavoured vaping products be restricted?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains why flavours may affect appeal and uptake

Middle

- Weighs youth protection against possible adult switching effects
- Considers enforcement and product substitution

End

- Gives a conditional view informed by outcome data

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming a flavour restriction has no unintended effects

To what extent should governments prevent young people from starting to smoke?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Identifies preventing youth smoking as a long-term health aim

Middle

- Considers education, access and marketing measures
- Weighs autonomy, enforcement and unequal exposure

End

- Supports proportionate evaluated action

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming information alone overcomes addiction and commercial influence

In what situations does public-health intervention become excessive interference with personal choice?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines a test for justified interference

Middle

- Weighs seriousness of harm, effectiveness and autonomy
- Considers least restrictive alternatives and distribution of burdens

End

- Uses a concrete example and review criteria

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating every restriction with unacceptable paternalism

To what extent should products that damage health be taxed more heavily?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Sets out health benefits and fairness concerns of taxation

Middle

- Considers behavioural response, substitution and household costs
- Discusses use of revenue and support for disadvantaged groups

End

- Judges policy by actual health and equity effects

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming regressive financial effects cannot be mitigated or do not matter

How could doctors approach conversations about vaping with teenagers?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Creates a respectful confidential conversation appropriate to the setting

Middle

- Asks about use, reasons and understanding without assumptions
- Explains uncertainty and support in age-appropriate language

End

- Agrees practical next steps and checks safeguarding needs

Mistakes to avoid

- Using threats or shame to force disclosure

Why do you think mental health has become an increasingly important part of healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains mental health's effect on functioning and wellbeing

Middle

- Discusses recognition, unmet need and links with physical health
- Distinguishes greater awareness from claims about exact prevalence

End

- Connects importance with accessible effective support

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming mental illness is simply a modern trend

To what extent should mental and physical illness receive equal priority within the NHS?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Affirms equal seriousness of mental and physical health needs

Middle

- Considers burden, access and evidence of benefit
- Explains that fair priority need not mean identical budgets

End

- Supports accountable equitable care

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating mental illness as less real or equating parity with a simplistic spending split

Which barriers prevent people from seeking mental-health support?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies barriers to seeking mental-health support

Middle

- Explains stigma, cost, waiting times or cultural concerns
- Matches barriers with practical access improvements

End

- Includes trusted confidential routes to help

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming people avoid help because they do not want to recover

What makes mental-health difficulties during childhood and adolescence an important healthcare concern?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises effects on development, relationships and education

Middle

- Discusses early support and family or school context
- Considers access and safeguarding without labelling ordinary emotions as illness

End

- Supports age-appropriate coordinated care

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming young people will simply grow out of every difficulty

How could medical schools better protect students' mental health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies pressures medical schools can influence

Middle

- Discusses workload, assessment culture and confidential support
- Includes accessible placements and early help-seeking

End

- Evaluates whether students can actually use support

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering resilience workshops while ignoring harmful conditions

How could doctors balance their own wellbeing with their professional responsibilities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises wellbeing supports safe sustainable care

Middle

- Explains boundaries, rest and appropriate cover
- Includes early help when health affects safe practice

End

- Balances duties through communication and support

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating self-neglect as a professional obligation

Encouraging resilience is often intended to support people. How could that message nevertheless make someone less willing to seek help?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how resilience messaging can imply blame

Middle

- Considers fear of appearing weak and pressure to cope alone
- Distinguishes personal coping from organisational responsibility

End

- Reframes resilience to include support and safer conditions

Mistakes to avoid

- Using resilience as a reason to tolerate unlimited workload

Which steps could be taken to reduce stigma surrounding mental illness?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies how stigma affects disclosure and access

Middle

- Discusses accurate language, lived experience and anti-discrimination
- Includes confidential practical support

End

- Checks whether attitudes and access improve

Mistakes to avoid

- Reducing stigma work to telling people to be positive

How might genomic medicine change healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains genomics as informing understanding of disease variation

Middle

- Discusses diagnosis or targeted treatment opportunities
- Considers uncertain findings, privacy and unequal access

End

- Balances potential with clinical validation

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming a genome predicts every future illness

Which benefits could whole-genome sequencing offer patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a patient benefit from broad genetic analysis

Middle

- Explains possible diagnostic or treatment insights
- Recognises incidental and uncertain results

End

- Links testing to counselling and useful clinical action

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming sequencing always provides a clear actionable answer

Which ethical concerns arise when sequencing a person's genome?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises genomic results can affect identity and relatives

Middle

- Discusses consent, privacy and unexpected findings
- Considers uncertainty, discrimination and the right not to know

End

- Supports informed choices and careful governance

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating genetic data like an ordinary anonymous measurement

Who do you think should have access to someone's genetic information?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Starts from confidentiality and legitimate need for access

Middle

- Distinguishes the patient, care team and secondary users
- Considers consent, safeguards and family implications

End

- Supports limited accountable access

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming relatives or employers automatically have a right to results

A newborn screening programme could check for many genetic conditions. What should parents consider before deciding whether to take part?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Considers screening through the child's welfare and future choices

Middle

- Weighs actionable benefit against uncertainty and unwanted findings
- Discusses consent, follow-up and privacy

End

- Distinguishes screening from a guaranteed diagnosis

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming testing for more conditions is always better

Genomic testing identifies a serious condition that cannot currently be treated. How should that finding be handled with the person tested?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks what the person consented to learn

Middle

- Explains the finding and its uncertainty sensitively
- Offers counselling and support without implying treatment exists

End

- Respects preferences and plans appropriate follow-up

Mistakes to avoid

- Disclosing complex results abruptly or promising a cure

A genetic test result may matter to a patient's relatives as well as the patient. How would you approach the question of sharing that information?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges both patient confidentiality and relatives' interests

Middle

- Explores consent and supported family communication
- Seeks specialist advice if a serious preventable risk raises a disclosure question

End

- Uses proportionate sharing and records reasoning

Mistakes to avoid

- Automatically releasing genetic information to the whole family

If personalised treatments are costly, what might determine who can benefit from them, and how could this affect health inequalities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies affordability and service access as barriers

Middle

- Considers testing availability and evidence across populations
- Examines prioritisation and opportunity cost

End

- Supports equitable appraisal and access safeguards

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming personalised medicine benefits all groups equally

Neighbouring communities can have markedly different health outcomes. Which local circumstances would you explore to understand that difference?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Starts with local evidence rather than stereotypes

Middle

- Compares housing, income, environment and service access
- Considers population composition and barriers within each community

End

- Identifies actionable explanations and remaining uncertainty

Mistakes to avoid

- Attributing neighbourhood differences to character or culture alone

When allocating NHS resources, how much weight should be given to the disadvantage experienced by a community?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Explains why disadvantage can signal unmet need

Middle

- Weighs equity alongside population size, severity and benefit
- Considers targeted resources and local participation

End

- Uses transparent needs-based allocation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming identical per-person spending always achieves fairness

How would you explain the difference between equality and equity in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes equal provision from support matched to barriers

Middle

- Uses a healthcare example such as accessible information
- Explains why different inputs may enable fair access

End

- Maintains equal dignity while tailoring support

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating equity as arbitrary preferential treatment

How could poverty influence health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies pathways linking poverty with health

Middle

- Explains food, heating, housing or insecure work constraints
- Recognises illness can also worsen financial hardship

End

- Supports practical and structural responses

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming poor health entirely on individual budgeting choices

How could housing influence health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains how housing conditions affect physical and mental health

Middle

- Considers damp, crowding, instability or accessibility
- Links housing with ability to manage illness

End

- Recognises partnership with housing and community services

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming a prescription can remove an unsafe living environment

How could education affect health outcomes?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Connects education with health through several pathways

Middle

- Discusses literacy, employment and ability to navigate services
- Recognises confounding and unequal opportunity

End

- Supports accessible health information regardless of education

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating less formal education with inability to make decisions

What practical steps can doctors take when a patient's health is affected by social circumstances beyond the consultation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Asks how social circumstances affect this patient's care

Middle

- Adapts the plan to practical barriers
- Offers appropriate referral, social support or advocacy

End

- Checks whether the proposed help is accessible

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving unrealistic advice without considering the patient's resources

In what ways could digital healthcare unintentionally exclude some patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a specific way digital systems can exclude

Middle

- Considers devices, connectivity, literacy, language or accessibility
- Discusses privacy and confidence as well as equipment

End

- Retains supported and non-digital access routes

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming owning a smartphone means being able to use digital healthcare

How would you explain the difference between assisted dying, assisted suicide and euthanasia?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises terminology varies by jurisdiction and debate

Middle

- Distinguishes a person taking supplied medication from another person administering it
- Separates definitions from claims about current legality

End

- Checks the relevant jurisdiction before describing legal rules

Mistakes to avoid

- Using assisted dying, assisted suicide and euthanasia as interchangeable terms

Which arguments are commonly made in favour of assisted dying?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Presents arguments supporting assisted dying fairly

Middle

- Explains autonomy and relief of intolerable suffering
- Considers dignity and limits of symptom relief without assuming all patients agree

End

- Acknowledges safeguards and counterarguments

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting support as the only compassionate position

What objections are raised to assisted dying, and how would you assess them?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies substantive objections respectfully

Middle

- Examines coercion, diagnostic uncertainty and unequal care
- Distinguishes evidence-based concerns from unsupported predictions

End

- Weighs whether proposed safeguards address the concerns

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing all opponents as uncaring or treating slippery-slope claims as established facts

How could legalised assisted dying affect the doctor-patient relationship?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the relationship could be affected in different ways

Middle

- Considers openness about suffering and patient choice
- Weighs fear, trust and changing expectations of doctors

End

- Supports clear roles and sensitive dialogue

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming every patient would experience the change identically

If assisted dying were permitted, what safeguards would you consider for people who might face pressure or coercion?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies sources of pressure or coercion

Middle

- Considers independent assessment, voluntary choice and repeated opportunities to reconsider
- Includes access to support and oversight

End

- Acknowledges safeguards reduce rather than eliminate risk

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating a signed request as proof of freedom from pressure

If assisted dying were legally available, how should the wishes of patients be balanced with doctors' objections to participating?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges patient wishes and clinicians' conscience

Middle

- Explores continuity, information and access within the hypothetical legal framework
- Considers respectful boundaries and organisational arrangements

End

- Avoids abandonment or coercion of either party

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming objection permits obstructing all access to information or care

How does access to good palliative care shape the arguments about assisted dying?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains how palliative care can affect suffering and choices

Middle

- Considers unequal access and whether alternatives are available
- Recognises good care may not resolve every person's concerns

End

- Treats palliative care as essential within either policy position

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming palliative care eliminates all suffering or makes the debate irrelevant

In a discussion of assisted dying, how would you weigh personal autonomy alongside the duty to preserve life?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- States the tension between autonomy and preserving life

Middle

- Examines voluntary informed wishes, vulnerability and professional duties
- Considers consequences and safeguards on both sides

End

- Offers a justified view without presenting it as the only ethical answer

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming one principle automatically settles every case

How can climate change affect human health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies direct and indirect health effects of climate change

Middle

- Discusses heat, air quality or changing infection patterns
- Considers food, displacement and unequal vulnerability

End

- Connects prevention with adaptation and health services

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing environmental effects without explaining health pathways

What responsibility should the NHS take for its environmental impact?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises healthcare both protects health and uses resources

Middle

- Considers energy, transport, procurement and waste
- Balances emissions reduction with reliable patient care

End

- Supports measurable organisational action

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating sustainability as solely an individual clinician's responsibility

To what extent should environmental sustainability influence clinical decision-making?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Places patient need and safety within the sustainability discussion

Middle

- Compares clinically appropriate options and resource effects
- Considers evidence, patient preferences and access

End

- Uses environmental impact as a relevant additional consideration

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing a less safe option solely for environmental reasons

A hospital wants to cut waste. How would you evaluate changes while protecting infection control and patient safety?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines the proposed waste reduction and its safety implications

Middle

- Checks infection-control evidence and staff workflow
- Pilots changes and monitors harm as well as waste

End

- Keeps or revises changes according to results

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming reuse is always safe or all single-use items are unnecessary

To what extent is climate change legitimately a medical issue?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains the link between climate and health

Middle

- Uses a concrete effect on patients or service resilience
- Considers a proportionate role for medical advocacy and expertise

End

- Connects climate action with prevention

Mistakes to avoid

- Discussing only environmental aesthetics without medical relevance

Which benefits could digital healthcare bring?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a concrete digital healthcare benefit

Middle

- Explains convenience, coordination or monitoring
- Considers who can access the benefit and what support is needed

End

- Evaluates outcomes rather than technology uptake alone

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming digital access suits every patient and task

What do you see as the disadvantages of relying more heavily on remote consultations?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies what can be lost in a remote consultation

Middle

- Discusses examination limits, privacy and missed communication cues
- Considers exclusion and escalation to in-person care

End

- Matches consultation mode to need

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating all remote care as either sufficient or unsafe

Which groups of patients might be disadvantaged by digital-first healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names groups facing particular digital barriers without stereotyping

Middle

- Explains affordability, disability, language or unstable housing mechanisms
- Recognises differences within groups

End

- Offers accessible alternatives and support

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming every older person is unable to use technology

Who do you think should own or control medical data?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes patient rights from custodianship and permitted use

Middle

- Considers care needs, access, privacy and public benefit
- Discusses accountable governance and meaningful transparency

End

- Avoids reducing control to a simple property claim

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming one organisation can use records for any purpose because it stores them

Researchers seek access to anonymised NHS patient records without asking each person for consent. What should govern that decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Examines the purpose and privacy implications of research access

Middle

- Checks whether anonymisation is robust and the use is appropriately authorised
- Considers independent oversight, public benefit and transparency

End

- Supports proportionate safeguards and applicable patient choices

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming the label anonymised removes every governance concern

How could the NHS balance medical innovation with privacy?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises innovation and privacy can both be legitimate aims

Middle

- Uses data minimisation and secure controlled access
- Considers evaluation, consent or other appropriate governance

End

- Builds trust through transparency and accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating privacy as an obstacle that must simply be removed

What concerns would you examine before allowing a commercial organisation to use health data?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies the commercial purpose and proposed data use

Middle

- Examines security, re-identification, onward sharing and public value
- Considers conflicts and enforceable limits

End

- Supports independent oversight and clear accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming payment alone makes access fair or acceptable

In what ways could wearable devices and health apps improve preventive medicine?

General

- Explains clear potential benefits
- Balances benefits against limitations
- Links technology directly to prevention
- Considers its impact on patients

Start

- Explains how monitoring could support earlier prevention
- Introduces one clear example

Middle

- Explains how technology could monitor health or behaviour
- Considers how this could encourage earlier action
- Considers limitations such as accuracy or accessibility
- Recognises technology may not benefit everyone equally

End

- Summarises how technology could support preventative healthcare
- Recognises professional judgement remains important
- Gives a balanced conclusion

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming technology can replace healthcare professionals
- Discussing only benefits
- Assuming all device data is reliable
- Ignoring accessibility or other limitations

Which factors cause obesity at a population level?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises population obesity reflects multiple interacting factors

Middle

- Explains food environments, activity opportunities and biological influences
- Considers deprivation and commercial pressures

End

- Distinguishes population causes from blaming individuals

Mistakes to avoid

- Reducing population trends to lack of willpower

How could society respond to increasing obesity rates?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Sets out responses at individual and population levels

Middle

- Combines accessible support with healthier environments
- Considers equity, feasibility and unintended stigma

End

- Evaluates health outcomes over time

Mistakes to avoid

- Proposing education alone as a complete solution

To what extent should governments regulate unhealthy food more strongly?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Frames food regulation around health, choice and fairness

Middle

- Considers marketing, composition or availability measures
- Weighs effectiveness, affordability and enforcement

End

- Offers proportionate evidence-informed regulation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all regulation works equally well

To what extent should sugary foods and drinks be taxed?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains how a sugar tax might influence consumption or reformulation

Middle

- Considers substitution, household costs and use of revenue
- Examines evidence of health and equity effects

End

- Gives a conditional balanced position

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming tax revenue alone proves health success

What would you consider when deciding whether to limit advertising of unhealthy foods aimed at children?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises children's vulnerability to advertising

Middle

- Weighs exposure and food preferences against scope and enforcement
- Considers digital advertising and unequal impact

End

- Defines outcomes to assess a restriction

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming parents alone can control every advertising exposure

To what extent should individuals take greater responsibility for lifestyle-related illness?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Balances individual agency with circumstances shaping behaviour

Middle

- Considers addiction, resources and social environments
- Distinguishes supportive responsibility from blame or denial of care

End

- Supports achievable choices and fair treatment

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all lifestyle risks are freely chosen

Which role should doctors play in tackling obesity?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines a respectful clinical role in obesity care

Middle

- Explores individual goals and contributing factors
- Offers evidence-informed support and appropriate referral

End

- Recognises wider environmental action is also needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Using shame or assuming weight is the patient's only concern

What do you see as the arguments for and against decriminalising currently illegal drugs?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Distinguishes decriminalisation from unrestricted legal supply

Middle

- Weighs reduced barriers to help against possible unintended effects
- Considers implementation and evidence from relevant contexts

End

- Judges policy through harm and equity outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating all drug policies or substances as identical

What might change if drug policy focused primarily on health needs rather than criminal penalties? How would you judge the results?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains a shift towards treatment and prevention

Middle

- Considers access, stigma and criminal-justice effects
- Proposes measures such as deaths, harm and engagement with support

End

- Acknowledges resources and evaluation are essential

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming changing penalties alone creates adequate treatment services

Which role should harm-reduction programmes play in drug policy?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines harm reduction as reducing adverse consequences

Middle

- Explains practical support and engagement with care
- Weighs effectiveness, access and community concerns

End

- Integrates harm reduction with broader prevention and treatment

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating reducing harm with endorsing drug use

To what extent should governments regulate alcohol more heavily?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Identifies health harms and freedom-of-choice considerations

Middle

- Compares pricing, marketing or availability approaches
- Considers unequal burdens and support for dependence

End

- Supports proportionate evaluated regulation

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming punishment alone resolves alcohol dependence

How could doctors approach addiction?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Approaches addiction as a health concern without judgement

Middle

- Explores needs, readiness and relevant risks
- Offers appropriate multidisciplinary support within competence

End

- Plans continuing care and recognises recovery may be non-linear

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating relapse as moral failure

To what extent is addiction a disease?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Explains biological and psychological aspects of dependence

Middle

- Recognises social influences and retained agency
- Discusses how the disease framing may reduce blame yet has limits

End

- Supports compassionate evidence-based care

Mistakes to avoid

- Using a disease label to imply change is impossible

How could socioeconomic disadvantage contribute to addiction?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies links between disadvantage and addiction risk

Middle

- Discusses stress, exposure and limited support
- Recognises addiction can further worsen disadvantage

End

- Supports accessible care and structural prevention

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming everyone in poverty develops addiction

Which role does education play in improving population health?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains education's contribution to health understanding and opportunity

Middle

- Considers accessible communication and lifelong learning
- Recognises resources are needed to act on knowledge

End

- Combines education with practical changes

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming knowing a risk guarantees behaviour change

A public-health campaign proposes using frightening messages to change behaviour. How would you assess that approach?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Examines whether frightening messages help the intended audience

Middle

- Considers avoidance, stigma and unequal effects
- Pairs clear risk with feasible protective action

End

- Evaluates behaviour and harm rather than shock value

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming stronger fear always produces better choices

How could public-health authorities communicate risk?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the audience and decision the risk message supports

Middle

- Uses absolute numbers, time frames and clear comparisons
- Communicates uncertainty and practical actions

End

- Checks understanding and updates messages

Mistakes to avoid

- Using relative risk alone to exaggerate danger

Which lessons can healthcare learn from successful public-health interventions of the past?

General

- Uses a relevant public-health example
- Explains why the intervention was successful
- Recognises the importance of prevention
- Links the example to wider healthcare lessons

Start

- Introduces one clear example
- Identifies the main lesson from it

Middle

- Explains how prevention improved health
- Considers accessibility and public engagement
- Recognises the importance of evidence and education
- Considers the effect on the wider population

End

- Draws out a broader lesson for modern healthcare
- Links successful public health to prevention and accessibility
- Recognises interventions should be evaluated and adapted

Mistakes to avoid

- Only listing interventions
- Giving examples without explaining why they worked
- Making unsupported claims
- Failing to link the example back to healthcare

You have noticed a medical student missing classes and avoiding social contact. How would you check in with them and decide whether further help is needed?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks in privately using observed changes rather than assumptions

Middle

- Listens to academic, social or wellbeing concerns
- Offers appropriate support and assesses immediate safety if indicated

End

- Agrees follow-up and escalates serious risk appropriately

Mistakes to avoid

- Diagnosing the student from attendance alone

A friend wants to withdraw from university but fears their family's reaction. How would you help them think through the conversation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explores the friend's reasons and fear of the family reaction

Middle

- Helps compare options and available university support
- Plans a safe honest conversation led by the friend's wishes

End

- Offers continued support without deciding for them

Mistakes to avoid

- Pressuring them to stay or leave

Your team keeps having to cover for a colleague who arrives late. How would you address the pattern with them?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Discusses the repeated lateness privately and factually

Middle

- Explores causes while explaining the effect on colleagues
- Agrees expectations and practical support

End

- Reviews the pattern and escalates persistent problems fairly

Mistakes to avoid

- Public criticism or assuming laziness before asking

You see one student copying another's work. Talk through how you would handle what you have observed.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Separates what was observed from assumptions

Middle

- Considers academic integrity and fair reporting processes
- Encourages honesty without promising to conceal misconduct

End

- Uses appropriate university procedures

Mistakes to avoid

- Spreading allegations or ignoring copying because the student is a friend

A friend wants your answers to an assignment that will be marked. How would you respond to the request?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Declines to share marked-assignment answers clearly

Middle

- Explains integrity and fairness without humiliating the friend
- Offers help understanding material or finding academic support

End

- Maintains the boundary if pressured

Mistakes to avoid

- Sharing answers with a request to reword them

Another student makes a disrespectful remark about a patient within your hearing. How would you address it?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the effect of the disrespectful remark

Middle

- Challenges it calmly and protects the patient's dignity
- Considers context, repetition and appropriate escalation

End

- Supports learning while ensuring concerns are addressed

Mistakes to avoid

- Laughing along or ignoring it to fit in

During a conversation, a patient starts shouting insults at you. How would you respond while keeping everyone safe?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Prioritises safety and a calm response

Middle

- Acknowledges distress while setting limits on abuse
- Maintains distance and seeks help if risk increases

End

- Continues appropriate care through a safe arrangement

Mistakes to avoid

- Arguing back or accepting threats as part of the job

After a long wait, a patient's relative angrily asks you why nothing is happening. How would you begin that conversation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the relative's frustration and listens

Middle

- Explains only verified information and respects confidentiality
- Checks for urgent needs and seeks an accurate update

End

- Gives a realistic next step without promising a time

Mistakes to avoid

- Inventing a reason for delay or disclosing private details without permission

You are already behind schedule when you meet a patient who is anxious and needs more time. How would you balance those demands?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the anxious patient's needs and effects on others waiting

Middle

- Clarifies immediate concerns and addresses safety
- Uses team support and communicates delays

End

- Agrees appropriate follow-up without abruptly dismissing the patient

Mistakes to avoid

- Sacrificing necessary care solely to keep to the timetable

Several urgent requests arrive together. Explain how you would decide what needs your attention first.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Rapidly identifies immediate danger and time-critical needs

Middle

- Checks consequences of delay and available support
- Delegates appropriate tasks with clear ownership

End

- Reassesses and communicates revised priorities

Mistakes to avoid

- Responding only in the order requests arrive

You suspect an important instruction has been misunderstood by another healthcare professional. How would you check and resolve this?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks the instruction and the colleague's understanding respectfully

Middle

- Uses clear clarification or read-back
- Stops a potentially harmful action and seeks senior help if necessary

End

- Confirms the corrected plan is understood

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming the colleague understood because they nodded

A senior member of staff asks you to take an action that you think could put a patient at risk. What would you say and do?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- States the safety concern respectfully and clearly

Middle

- Clarifies the instruction and their competence
- Pauses unsafe action and escalates through appropriate channels

End

- Ensures the concern is resolved rather than merely voiced

Mistakes to avoid

- Following a risky instruction solely because it came from a senior

An unattended computer is displaying confidential patient details. How would you deal with the immediate issue and any further concerns?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Protects the screen from unauthorised viewing without browsing records

Middle

- Secures it according to local procedure and alerts responsible staff
- Considers whether a confidentiality incident occurred

End

- Reports relevant facts and supports prevention

Mistakes to avoid

- Reading or photographing the displayed details as evidence

You discover that you have sent information to an unintended recipient. How would you respond to the mistake?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises the need to act promptly on the misdirected information

Middle

- Notifies appropriate supervision or information-governance staff
- Follows containment advice and records what was sent

End

- Supports required follow-up and prevention

Mistakes to avoid

- Trying to conceal the mistake or assuming recall guarantees deletion

A patient asks something you cannot answer confidently. How would you respond without misleading them?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the limit of their knowledge honestly

Middle

- Clarifies the question and finds reliable help
- Explains when and how an answer will be obtained

End

- Follows through with accurate information

Mistakes to avoid

- Guessing to avoid appearing uncertain

A patient would like your personal mobile number for future questions. How would you respond and discuss ways to obtain help?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the patient's wish for accessible help

Middle

- Explains a professional boundary around personal contact
- Offers appropriate service contact and urgent-help routes

End

- Checks the patient knows how to obtain support

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving a personal number without considering boundaries or continuity

A colleague's public social-media post about work strikes you as unprofessional. How would you decide what action to take?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks the post's content and potential harm before judging

Middle

- Considers confidentiality, accuracy and discriminatory content
- Raises concerns privately or escalates urgent risks

End

- Uses proportionate professional processes

Mistakes to avoid

- Reposting the material to criticise the colleague publicly

Just before an important team task, you notice that a colleague is distressed. How would you check what support they need?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Checks privately what the distressed colleague needs

Middle

- Listens and considers their ability to take part safely
- Arranges support or task cover without demanding disclosure

End

- Follows up after the immediate task

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring distress because the task is important

A colleague says they are coping, although you have noticed signs that make you worry about burnout. How would you approach the conversation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Shares specific observations without diagnosing burnout

Middle

- Respects the colleague's account while offering support
- Discusses workload and appropriate help, escalating immediate safety risks

End

- Keeps the door open and checks in again

Mistakes to avoid

- Arguing that they must be unwell or promising unlimited secrecy

A staff member is targeted by a discriminatory remark from a patient. What response would you expect from the rest of the team?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Supports the targeted staff member and addresses the remark

Middle

- Sets respectful boundaries while maintaining necessary patient care
- Seeks team or senior support and documents appropriately

End

- Follows up with the colleague and addresses recurrence

Mistakes to avoid

- Excusing discrimination because it came from a patient

A healthcare budget can fund either substantial relief from chronic pain for a large group or life-saving procedures for a smaller, critically ill group. How would you weigh the options?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises both chronic suffering and immediate threats to life

Middle

- Compares severity, benefit and numbers without assuming one always wins
- Considers alternatives and opportunity cost

End

- Justifies a transparent allocation process

Mistakes to avoid

- Dismissing pain relief as unimportant because it does not save life

One donated organ could help either of two patients who need it. What would a fair process for deciding between them involve?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Uses an established fair organ-allocation process

Middle

- Considers compatibility, urgency and expected benefit
- Explains independent criteria and review

End

- Avoids making an unsupported personal ranking

Mistakes to avoid

- Choosing by wealth, family status or perceived social contribution

The NHS is considering a costly cancer medicine that offers a few extra months of life. What should be weighed when deciding whether to fund it?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Acknowledges extra months may be meaningful to the patient

Middle

- Weighs quality of life, side effects and strength of evidence
- Considers cost, alternatives and opportunity cost

End

- Supports a transparent appraisal with patient input

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming a short life extension is either priceless or worthless

Only a small group of patients benefits from a treatment, but the benefit for that group is large. How would you approach a funding decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Separates size of the eligible group from size of benefit

Middle

- Examines evidence, need and total resource impact
- Considers identifying responders fairly

End

- Justifies value without relying only on patient numbers

Mistakes to avoid

- Rejecting treatment simply because few people benefit

How would you assess funding for a rare-disease treatment whose cost per patient is very high?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises rare disease can create high unmet need and limited evidence

Middle

- Weighs benefit, uncertainty and high per-person cost
- Considers fair exceptions and evidence development

End

- Explains a consistent transparent review process

Mistakes to avoid

- Automatically excluding rare conditions or funding them without scrutiny

To what extent is it fair to use age when deciding how to allocate limited healthcare resources?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Distinguishes chronological age from clinically relevant factors

Middle

- Considers individual prognosis and need
- Examines fairness and discriminatory assumptions

End

- Uses age only where justified by relevant evidence

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating age alone as a measure of a life's value

A service must balance long waits against the greater clinical needs of newly referred patients. How should it set priorities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises harm from both urgent need and prolonged waiting

Middle

- Uses clinical risk alongside time waited and functional impact
- Provides reassessment when circumstances change

End

- Communicates priorities and supports those delayed

Mistakes to avoid

- Always prioritising either new referrals or the longest wait

A prevention programme may take decades to show its full benefit. How would you judge its claim on funding needed for care today?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges long-term prevention competes with present care

Middle

- Examines evidence, time to benefit and uncertainty
- Considers intergenerational fairness and transition costs

End

- Justifies a balanced funding horizon

Mistakes to avoid

- Discounting future patients entirely or neglecting people needing care now

With limited healthcare resources, how would you weigh improving quality of life against extending life?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Treats quality and length of life as distinct valued outcomes

Middle

- Explores patient preferences and treatment burdens
- Considers evidence and fair resource use

End

- Offers a reasoned balance without a universal ranking

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming disability makes life extension less valuable

How should clinicians, elected representatives, economists, patients and independent bodies contribute to NHS funding decisions, and who should be accountable for the final choice?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies each group's relevant contribution

Middle

- Combines clinical evidence, economic analysis and lived experience
- Explains democratic legitimacy, independence and conflicts

End

- Names transparent accountability for the final decision

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving every stakeholder input without identifying who is accountable

How would you explain what professionalism means to you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains professionalism through their own conduct and values

Middle

- Uses a concrete example of honesty, reliability or respect
- Recognises accountability when standards are difficult to maintain

End

- Shows how they would continue developing professionally

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving only an abstract definition with no practical meaning

To what extent should doctors be held to higher standards of behaviour than members of the general public?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises special trust and responsibility attached to medicine

Middle

- Weighs professional obligations against privacy and ordinary human fallibility
- Distinguishes relevant standards from intrusive perfectionism

End

- Supports proportionate expectations

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming doctors surrender all private rights

Can a doctor's behaviour outside work matter professionally?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains why some outside-work behaviour may affect trust or safety

Middle

- Considers confidentiality, dishonesty or discriminatory conduct
- Distinguishes serious relevance from personal preference

End

- Uses proportionality and context

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating every unpopular private choice as professional misconduct

How could doctors use social media?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies constructive professional uses of social media

Middle

- Discusses education, engagement or peer learning
- Explains confidentiality, accuracy and boundary safeguards

End

- Recognises public reach and permanence

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating a private account as guaranteeing privacy

A doctor wants to discuss a patient online after removing identifying details. What should they consider before posting?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises removing obvious identifiers may be insufficient

Middle

- Considers indirect identification and the purpose of discussion
- Checks consent and appropriate secure alternatives

End

- Prioritises confidentiality over an interesting post

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming anonymity can be guaranteed by omitting names

Why do you think professional boundaries are important?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains boundaries protect patients and professional judgement

Middle

- Discusses power imbalance, trust and dependence
- Uses a practical example of appropriate limits

End

- Combines warmth with clear roles

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating boundaries with being cold or inaccessible

To what extent can a doctor become friends with a patient?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Weighs credible arguments on both sides before giving a justified, balanced view

Start

- Recognises friendship may blur a therapeutic relationship

Middle

- Considers vulnerability, power and conflicts of interest
- Distinguishes incidental community contact from seeking personal intimacy

End

- Seeks guidance and protects professional boundaries

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming patient agreement removes the power imbalance

A patient sends their doctor a social-media friend request. How should the doctor decide how to respond?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the request without accepting automatically

Middle

- Explains personal-professional separation and privacy
- Offers suitable professional communication routes

End

- Applies a consistent respectful boundary

Mistakes to avoid

- Using a patient friend request to move care into private messages

How could a doctor respond when a colleague behaves unprofessionally?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Assesses the observed behaviour and immediate risk

Middle

- Addresses concerns factually and proportionately
- Uses appropriate reporting or supervision for serious issues

End

- Follows up rather than assuming the concern is resolved

Mistakes to avoid

- Gossiping about the colleague or ignoring repeated harm

What do you think should happen if a doctor is not fit to work safely?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Puts safe patient cover and the doctor's support first

Middle

- Seeks appropriate senior or occupational-health input
- Avoids unsupported diagnosis and punitive assumptions

End

- Plans safe review and return where appropriate

Mistakes to avoid

- Allowing unsafe work to continue out of sympathy

Why do you think raising concerns is sometimes difficult in healthcare?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies barriers such as hierarchy and fear of repercussions

Middle

- Explains uncertainty, loyalty and previous responses to concerns
- Considers supportive reporting systems and leadership

End

- Connects psychological safety with learning

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming junior staff for silence without considering the environment

Which responsibilities do junior staff have if they are worried about a senior colleague?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises junior status does not remove safety responsibilities

Middle

- Clarifies and records factual concerns
- Escalates through suitable channels if the senior does not respond

End

- Ensures risk receives attention and seeks support

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming a senior's authority settles a safety concern

How would you explain what honesty means in medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines honesty as accurate transparent communication

Middle

- Includes uncertainty, errors and limits of competence
- Distinguishes tact from misleading omission

End

- Connects honesty with trust and accountability

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming good intentions justify fabricated reassurance

Why is trust especially important in the relationship between doctors and patients?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Explains patient vulnerability and dependence on professional advice

Middle

- Connects trust with disclosure and shared decisions
- Discusses confidentiality, reliability and candour

End

- Recognises trust must be earned and repaired

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming patients owe trust because of a doctor's title

How would you respond if loyalty to a colleague came into conflict with protecting a patient?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Prioritises patient protection while supporting the colleague

Middle

- Explains why concealment is not constructive loyalty
- Encourages appropriate disclosure and escalates if needed

End

- Supports learning and fair treatment alongside safety

Mistakes to avoid

- Covering up harm to preserve a friendship

Speak with a fellow student whose attendance at teaching has dropped. Explore what is happening and what support they might need.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Opens privately with a gentle observation about attendance

Middle

- Uses open questions and listens without assuming the cause
- Offers academic or wellbeing support based on their response

End

- Agrees a manageable next step and follow-up

Mistakes to avoid

- Accusing the student of laziness or conducting an interrogation

A friend has just failed an exam that mattered to them. Show how you would begin a supportive conversation.

General

- Shows genuine empathy
- Uses active listening
- Maintains calm and appropriate communication
- Responds to emotion before trying to solve the problem

Start

- Acknowledges that the friend seems upset
- Uses an open question
- Allows time for them to respond

Middle

- Listens without interrupting
- Acknowledges and validates their feelings
- Checks what support they want
- Avoids forcing advice on them

End

- Offers continued support
- Allows the friend control over next steps
- Checks whether they need anything else

Mistakes to avoid

- Immediately saying “don’t worry”
- Giving advice before listening
- Making the conversation about themselves
- Minimising how the friend feels

Tell someone that an event they were excited about has been cancelled, and respond to their reaction.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Gives the cancellation news clearly and sensitively

Middle

- Pauses for the person's reaction
- Explains only known reasons and explores what matters to them

End

- Discusses available alternatives without false promises

Mistakes to avoid

- Delaying the core news with a long preamble

A customer feels they have been treated unfairly and is angry. Demonstrate how you would listen and respond.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Acknowledges the customer's frustration and invites their account

Middle

- Listens without arguing and clarifies the unfairness they describe
- Explains realistic options within their role

End

- Agrees a next step and checks it addresses the concern

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising compensation or outcomes they cannot authorise

Explain clearly a simple scientific concept to someone with no scientific background.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Chooses a simple concept and checks starting knowledge

Middle

- Explains it accurately in small plain-language steps
- Uses a suitable analogy and checks its limits

End

- Invites the listener to explain their understanding

Mistakes to avoid

- Using unexplained jargon or an analogy that misrepresents the concept

Explain clearly how to use a common everyday object without demonstrating it.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Identifies the object, purpose and starting position verbally

Middle

- Gives ordered concrete instructions without relying on gestures
- Includes necessary safety points and checks progress

End

- Confirms the listener can describe the completed action

Mistakes to avoid

- Using here or like this when no demonstration is available

Speak with someone who is worried about an upcoming medical procedure. Explore their concerns and offer appropriate support.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Asks what specifically worries the person about the procedure

Middle

- Listens and responds to the expressed emotion
- Offers reliable information within their knowledge and routes questions to the team

End

- Checks understanding and agrees support

Mistakes to avoid

- Guaranteeing a painless or complication-free procedure

Talk with a patient's relative who is frustrated about the length of the hospital wait.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Acknowledges the relative's frustration about waiting

Middle

- Explores immediate concerns and checks available updates
- Respects confidentiality and avoids blaming staff

End

- Gives a realistic next step and escalation for deterioration

Mistakes to avoid

- Inventing a waiting-time promise to calm them

Help someone explore a possible change to their lifestyle, giving them room to make their own decision.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Asks permission to discuss the possible lifestyle change

Middle

- Explores goals, readiness and barriers with open questions
- Offers options while preserving choice

End

- Agrees a small achievable step if the person wants one

Mistakes to avoid

- Lecturing or assuming they are ready to change

Have a conversation with someone who is unsure about vaccination. Find out what matters to them before responding.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Invites the person's particular vaccination concern

Middle

- Listens before giving tailored clear information
- Acknowledges uncertainty and checks reliable evidence

End

- Encourages questions and leaves discussion open

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating hesitation as an argument to win

Show how you would support someone who has just heard upsetting news.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Acknowledges the upsetting news and allows silence

Middle

- Responds to emotional cues without assuming feelings
- Asks what support or company the person wants

End

- Offers a manageable next step and ongoing support

Mistakes to avoid

- Making the exchange about their own similar experience

Explain clearly why antibiotics may not be appropriate for a viral infection.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Explains that antibiotics act against bacteria rather than viruses

Middle

- Uses a clear accessible explanation of limited benefit and possible harms
- Discusses appropriate support and when to seek further assessment

End

- Checks understanding without dismissing the illness

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying nothing can be done because the illness is viral

Discuss a concern with a colleague whose behaviour has been causing difficulties for the team.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Raises a specific behaviour privately and respectfully

Middle

- Explains its effect on the team without attacking personality
- Listens to context and agrees practical changes

End

- Sets a review point and appropriate escalation if needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Making vague accusations or speaking for everyone without evidence

You have made a mistake that affects someone else. Demonstrate how you would apologise and discuss what happens next.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Acknowledges the mistake and apologises directly

Middle

- Explains known effects without excuses
- Listens to the person's response and offers realistic corrective action

End

- Explains follow-up and prevention

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying sorry only if they were offended or shifting blame

Give feedback to someone whose recent performance fell short, keeping the conversation constructive.

General

- Respectful and calm communication
- Specific rather than personal feedback
- Listens to the other person
- Works collaboratively towards improvement

Start

- Uses an appropriate private setting
- Introduces the concern clearly but sensitively
- Allows the person an opportunity to respond

Middle

- Uses specific examples of the problem
- Explains the impact
- Listens to their perspective or circumstances
- Agrees realistic improvements and support together

End

- Summarises agreed next steps
- Checks that both people understand the plan
- Arranges follow-up if appropriate

Mistakes to avoid

- Criticising them publicly
- Attacking their personality rather than behaviour
- Doing all the talking
- Avoiding the problem completely

Someone raises concerns about your performance. Demonstrate how you would listen, respond and decide what to do next.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Listens to the performance concern without interrupting

Middle

- Asks for examples and checks understanding
- Acknowledges useful feedback and discusses unclear points respectfully

End

- Agrees an improvement and review plan

Mistakes to avoid

- Becoming defensive or accepting criticism without understanding it

Help two people in a group talk through a disagreement and work towards a way forward.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Establishes a respectful shared purpose for the discussion

Middle

- Gives both people space and summarises each concern
- Finds common ground and compares possible solutions

End

- Confirms an agreed next step and responsibilities

Mistakes to avoid

- Taking sides or forcing agreement before understanding the dispute

Talk someone through a complicated set of instructions so they can follow each step.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Checks the listener's goal and starting knowledge

Middle

- Breaks instructions into ordered manageable chunks
- Pauses to check progress and clarifies difficult steps

End

- Uses a recap or teach-back to confirm the whole sequence

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving every instruction at once without checking comprehension

Talk me through the GP appointment-wait chart. How have North and South changed over time, and how fair is it to compare them?

Image: GP appointment waits across two districts
Source facts: Routine appointments, 2019–2024. Mean wait in days, in year order: North 6, 7, 11, 13, 12, 10; South 5, 6, 8, 9, 11, 12. Practices submitting data: North 18, 18, 17, 15, 15, 14; South 20, 20, 20, 21, 22, 22. North introduced online triage in January 2022; South in January 2024. Annual means use each year's reporting practices. Urgent appointments excluded. Patient age and appointment demand were not recorded. Fictional regional audit.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Identifies what the graph measures and the groups being compared (e.g. routine GP waiting times in two districts)

Middle

- Recognises the general upward, downward or unchanged trend (e.g. North rises to a 13-day peak in 2022, then falls)
- Compares patterns between groups using relevant figures (e.g. South rises from 5 to 12 days and overtakes North)
- Recognises limits to a fair comparison (e.g. different practices reported each year and demand was not recorded)

End

- Summarises the main finding without claiming an unproven cause (e.g. the chart alone cannot show the effect of online triage)

Mistakes to avoid

- Misreading the overall trend or treating a possible explanation as proven (e.g. saying North waits fell overall)

Use the smoking-cessation table to compare the chances of quitting in each programme. How do people missing from follow-up affect your interpretation?

Image: Six-month smoking cessation programme results
Source facts: Service evaluation of three self-selected programmes. Columns: enrolled; followed up; reported quitting; still smoking; not followed up. Text support: 200; 150; 48; 102; 50. Group sessions: 120; 108; 43; 65; 12. One-to-one support: 80; 60; 30; 30; 20. Mean age, median cigarettes/day at entry and total cost: text 29, 12, £8,000; group 46, 18, £18,000; one-to-one 52, 22, £24,000. Participants chose their programme. Quitting was self-reported at six months, without biochemical confirmation. Quitters and still-smoking counts refer only to those followed up. Missing outcomes are unknown. Fictional data.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Checks who is included in each result and whether outcomes are missing (e.g. enrolled participants versus those followed up)

Middle

- Compares groups using appropriate percentages (e.g. 48/150 = 32%, 43/108 ≈ 40% and 30/60 = 50%)
- Explains how missing results affect interpretation (e.g. known quitters are 24%, about 36% and 37.5% of everyone enrolled, but missing outcomes are unknown)
- Recognises differences between groups and how results were measured (e.g. people chose their programme and quitting was self-reported)

End

- Separates the best observed result from proof that an option is best (e.g. the highest observed quitting percentage does not prove one-to-one support is most effective)

Mistakes to avoid

- Comparing raw totals without considering group size or guessing missing outcomes (e.g. assuming everyone not followed up was still smoking)

What story do the exercise and wellbeing results suggest for each age group? Give another explanation for the pattern before deciding whether exercise is responsible.

Image: Weekly exercise and reported wellbeing
Source facts: Cross-sectional online survey of 240 adults. Exercise groups: less than 1 hour, 1–3 hours, 4–6 hours, more than 6 hours weekly. Mean wellbeing scores out of 10 (95% confidence interval; sample size), in group order. Ages 18–39: 5.4 (4.9–5.9; 30), 6.2 (5.8–6.6; 45), 7.1 (6.7–7.5; 30), 6.9 (6.0–7.8; 15). Ages 40–65: 4.9 (4.4–5.4; 35), 5.8 (5.4–6.2; 40), 6.5 (6.0–7.0; 30), 6.7 (5.7–7.7; 15). The chart shows means; intervals are in the table. Exercise and wellbeing were self-reported. Income, health conditions and sleep were not recorded. Fictional data.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Identifies the variables and distinguishes a relationship from cause and effect (e.g. exercise and wellbeing)

Middle

- Recognises the general positive, negative or neutral trend and any exceptions (e.g. wellbeing generally rises up to 4–6 hours of exercise)
- Considers how group size affects confidence in a finding (e.g. the highest-exercise groups are smaller)
- Identifies other explanations or measurement limits (e.g. self-reported results and unrecorded sleep, income or health)

End

- Gives a cautious conclusion that fits the evidence (e.g. the survey cannot establish the best amount of exercise)

Mistakes to avoid

- Overstating a pattern or claiming a definite cause (e.g. saying more exercise always improves wellbeing)

You are choosing a community diabetes programme with £200,000 for its first year. Make a recommendation using the table, then explain what you would check before committing.

Image: Options for a community diabetes programme
Source facts: First-year budget £200,000; funding for one programme. Columns: annual invitations, expected attendance, annual running cost, one-off setup cost. Mobile clinic: 1,200, 68%, £180,000, £35,000. Evening clinic: 800, 81%, £120,000, £15,000. Online support: 2,400, 42%, £90,000, £45,000. Mobile launches in 5 months and needs two nurses for weekly rural visits. Evening launches in 2 months with one nurse at a town-centre site. Online launches in 3 months and requires internet access and a remote educator. Budget covers setup and running costs; no extra funding confirmed. Attendance estimates come from small pilots in different areas. An estimated 18% of the local target population lacks reliable internet. Health outcomes, long-term retention and adverse effects were not measured. Fictional planning data.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Identifies the decision and its practical limits (e.g. a £200,000 first-year budget covering setup and running costs)

Middle

- Checks whether each option is feasible using the relevant totals (e.g. mobile £215,000, evening £135,000 and online £135,000)
- Compares benefits, access and practical demands (e.g. attendance, staffing and internet access)
- Identifies missing information that could change the decision (e.g. health outcomes and longer-term attendance)

End

- Justifies an affordable choice while remaining open to new evidence (e.g. either evening or online support could be defended)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring a stated limit or assuming activity guarantees benefit (e.g. choosing the mobile clinic without extra funding)

Look across the wards: how do admissions vary with discharge delays? Pick a result that stands out and suggest what you would investigate.

Image: Ward admissions and discharge delays
Source facts: Twenty sampled ward-days across two wards. Scatterplot: daily admissions on x-axis; mean time from discharge decision to leaving in hours on y-axis. Approximate plotted pairs for Ward A: (12,2.1), (16,2.8), (20,2.4), (24,3.3), (28,3.0), (32,3.8), (36,3.4), (40,4.4), (44,4.0), (48,4.8). Ward B: (14,2.8), (18,3.5), (22,3.1), (24,7.5), (26,4.0), (30,3.6), (34,4.5), (38,4.0), (42,5.0), (46,4.6). Ward A has 28 beds, median nurse-to-patient ratio 1:6, and 2 of 10 sampled days at weekends. Ward B has 36 beds, ratio 1:8, and 4 of 10 days at weekends. Sampling covered six weeks. Patient complexity and transport availability were not recorded. Fictional audit.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Explains what each plotted point and axis represent (e.g. a sampled ward-day, admissions and discharge delay in hours)

Middle

- Identifies an unusual result using a reasonable visual estimate (e.g. Ward B near 24 admissions and 7.5 hours)
- Recognises the general positive, negative or neutral relationship (e.g. more admissions tend to accompany longer delays)
- Suggests plausible explanations to investigate (e.g. staffing, patient needs or transport availability)

End

- Explains how an unusual result should be checked before drawing conclusions (e.g. reviewing that day’s records rather than automatically removing the point)

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming an unusual value is an error or misreading units (e.g. confusing hours with days)

A briefing describes patient satisfaction as rising sharply. Use the figure to explain the comparison and whether its presentation gives a fair impression.

Image: Patient satisfaction briefing
Source facts: Hospital communications headline: Patient satisfaction rises sharply. 2024 inpatient survey bar chart: Hospital A 82%, Hospital B 86%; vertical axis runs from 80% to 87%. Measure: overall satisfaction with inpatient care. Hospital A: 2,000 invitations, 500 responses, 410 answered yes; anonymous postal form, January–March. Hospital B: 1,000 invitations, 100 responses, 86 answered yes; Interview with ward staff, October–December. Respondents were adults discharged from inpatient wards. Patient age, illness severity and previous-year results were not provided. Fictional communications extract.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Checks whether the headline describes what the data actually show (e.g. comparing two hospitals does not show a rise over time)

Middle

- Recognises how the scale can exaggerate differences (e.g. an axis starting at 80% exaggerates a 4 percentage-point difference)
- Considers response rates and whether respondents represent the wider group (e.g. 25% versus 10% responded)
- Checks whether groups were measured in comparable ways (e.g. different survey methods and times of year)

End

- Suggests a clearer presentation that includes relevant context (e.g. the full scale, response numbers and limitations)

Mistakes to avoid

- Accepting a misleading headline or treating presentation problems as proof of false data (e.g. saying satisfaction rose over time)

Compare the vaccination patterns in North and South. Which changes deserve further investigation, and what evidence would you need to explain them?

Image: Childhood vaccination uptake
Source facts: Completed scheduled vaccinations by age two, 2018–2024. Percent eligible children vaccinated in year order: North 93, 92, 89, 86, 87, 89, 91; South 94, 93, 91, 90, 90, 92, 93. Eligible children recorded: North 1,000, 1,000, 1,100, 1,200, 1,300, 1,400, 1,500; South 1,500, 1,500, 1,600, 1,600, 1,700, 1,700, 1,800. In 2021 both districts updated child-registration records. In 2022 North introduced reminder texts. In 2023 both added weekend clinics. Uptake uses each year's registered eligible population. Migration and individual reasons for missed vaccination were not recorded. Fictional audit.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Recognises the overall trend and changes in direction (e.g. vaccination uptake falls and then partly recovers)

Middle

- Supports the comparison with relevant figures (e.g. North 93% to 86% to 91% and South 94% to 90% to 93%)
- Suggests possible explanations without treating them as proven (e.g. reminders or weekend clinics)
- Recognises changes in the population or information collected (e.g. eligible numbers changed and reasons for missed vaccination were unknown)

End

- Explains what further comparison would help test an explanation (e.g. similar areas with and without a service change)

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming that events happening together prove a cause (e.g. crediting reminder texts alone for the recovery)

Explain the sleep and exam-score scatterplot to another student. How does revision time complicate the claim that more sleep leads to better marks?

Image: Average nightly sleep and exam score
Source facts: Survey of 40 students sitting the same exam; 40 of 120 invited responded. Scatterplot x-axis self-reported sleep 4–10 hours/night, y-axis exam score 40–100%. Twenty students per revision group. Approximate under-10-hours/week pairs: (4.3,46), (4.6,60), (4.9,51), (5.2,65), (5.5,49), (5.8,68), (6.1,56), (6.4,72), (6.6,45), (6.7,59), (7.0,76), (7.3,62), (7.6,71), (7.9,65), (8.2,80), (8.5,68), (8.8,74), (9.1,70), (9.4,83), (9.7,73). Approximate 10-plus-hours/week pairs: (4.4,58), (4.7,72), (5.0,61), (5.3,77), (5.6,64), (5.9,80), (6.2,67), (6.5,83), (6.8,69), (7.1,86), (7.4,73), (7.7,90), (7.85,58), (8.0,76), (8.3,88), (8.6,79), (8.9,93), (9.2,82), (9.5,89), (9.8,85). Sleep and revision were recalled after the exam. Prior attainment, stress, health and caffeine were not recorded. Fictional student survey.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Recognises the general positive, negative or neutral relationship and the spread of results (e.g. more sleep tends to accompany higher scores, with variation)

Middle

- Considers how another measured factor affects the comparison (e.g. revision time differs between groups)
- Recognises sampling and measurement limits (e.g. 40 of 120 students responded and recalled sleep after the exam)
- Suggests other possible explanations (e.g. prior attainment, stress or caffeine)

End

- Distinguishes an observed relationship from a proven effect (e.g. the survey cannot show that extra sleep causes higher marks)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring other relevant factors or claiming a precise effect for everyone (e.g. an exact mark gain for each extra hour of sleep)

Use the heart-event chart to explain the new treatment to a patient. Balance the possible benefit against bleeding, extra tablets and monitoring.

Image: Chance of another heart event within five years
Source facts: Fictional randomised treatment study with 1,000 adults per group and complete five-year outcomes. Standard care: 20 in 100 had another heart event; 3 in 100 had major bleeding; no extra tablets or visits. Standard care plus new treatment: 15 in 100 had another heart event; 6 in 100 had major bleeding; one extra daily tablet; two extra monitoring visits per year. Each chart icon represents 1 in 100 people. Heart events and major bleeding may affect the same person. Individual risks may differ.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Uses a clear time period and an understandable way to express risk (e.g. outcomes over five years, out of 100 people)

Middle

- Explains the size of a potential benefit in plain language (e.g. 20 versus 15 heart events out of 100 means 5 fewer)
- Balances the benefit with possible harm (e.g. bleeding increases from 3 to 6 out of 100)
- Considers practical burden and individual differences (e.g. an extra tablet, monitoring visits and different personal risks)

End

- Summarises the trade-off without making the decision for everyone (e.g. fewer heart events must be weighed against bleeding and treatment burden)

Mistakes to avoid

- Overstating benefit or leaving out important harm (e.g. quoting only a relative percentage or implying every event is prevented)

A patient is deciding between the two physiotherapy programmes. Compare recovery over time and the practical commitments, and explain where the evidence leaves uncertainty.

Image: Recovery after two physiotherapy programmes
Source facts: 200 adults randomly assigned, 100 per programme. At 12 weeks, categories much better / a little better / no better or worse / did not respond: A 54 / 26 / 15 / 5; B 62 / 23 / 10 / 5. At six months: A 50 / 20 / 18 / 12; B 52 / 18 / 12 / 18. All counts use the original 100 per group. A has 4 supervised sessions, typical 20-minute travel per session, 10 in 100 reporting a temporary pain flare. B has 8 sessions, 50-minute travel, 18 in 100 reporting a flare. Missing outcomes unknown. Recovery self-reported; participants knew their programme. Both received home exercises. No follow-up beyond six months. Fictional study.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Checks the original group sizes and what missing responses mean (e.g. 100 per programme and unknown outcomes for non-responders)

Middle

- Compares outcomes at each relevant time point (e.g. 80 versus 85 report some improvement at 12 weeks)
- Recognises whether an early difference lasts (e.g. both groups have 70 reporting some improvement at six months)
- Balances outcomes with burden, harm and missing information (e.g. session numbers, travel time and pain flares)

End

- Gives a balanced conclusion that reflects uncertainty (e.g. similar later results do not prove the programmes are equally effective)

Mistakes to avoid

- Guessing missing outcomes or claiming a lasting advantage without enough evidence (e.g. counting non-responders as recovered)

Read the energy-drink study as though you were checking an advert. Which features make its concentration claim more or less convincing?

Image: Energy drinks and concentration
Source facts: 60 volunteers aged 18–30 recruited via the maker's social media chose an energy drink or water. One-hour test, no blinding. Drink/water: enrolled 36/24; completed both tests 33/21; mean score before out of 100 48/49; after 54/50; regular caffeine users 24/33 and 8/21. Scores are for completers. Report states the drink group scored 8% higher than water after one hour. Company-funded. Sleep and other caffeine unrecorded. Fictional study.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Identifies how study design could influence the results (e.g. participants chose their drink and knew what they received)

Middle

- Checks whether the groups were similar before the study (e.g. different levels of regular caffeine use)
- Considers missing participants and unmeasured factors (e.g. sleep and other caffeine)
- Checks the reported claim against the actual comparison (e.g. considering both final scores and change from the starting score)

End

- Explains how weaknesses affect confidence without dismissing all findings (e.g. company funding calls for scrutiny but does not itself prove fraud)

Mistakes to avoid

- Misdescribing the design or treating one limitation as proof of false results (e.g. calling the study randomised)

The reminder-text pilot suggests fewer missed appointments. Explain how much confidence you would put in that result and what a larger study should clarify.

Image: Reminder texts and missed appointments
Source facts: 24 adults, random allocation, one clinic, four weeks. Extra text: 2/12 missed an appointment, 10 attended. Usual care: 4/12 missed, 8 attended. Two texts were undelivered; participants analysed as assigned. £0.08 per text, staff costs unrecorded. Report says difference not statistically significant. No sample-size calculation or confidence interval. Phone owners only, one appointment each, complete follow-up. Fictional pilot study.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Considers whether the sample is large and varied enough for a firm conclusion (e.g. 24 adults from one clinic)

Middle

- Expresses the result in both numbers and context (e.g. 2 of 12 versus 4 of 12 missed appointments, a difference of two people)
- Recognises useful features as well as limitations (e.g. random allocation and complete follow-up, but two undelivered texts)
- Explains what further evidence would improve confidence (e.g. a larger study across several clinics)

End

- Gives a proportionate conclusion about the strength of the evidence (e.g. promising but too small for a firm claim)

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating an apparent large percentage change as conclusive or selectively removing participants (e.g. excluding undelivered texts)

A hospital wants to adopt the asthma-app after this evaluation. What would you ask about the measurements, missing participants and other changes before accepting the findings?

Image: Asthma app: eight-week evaluation
Source facts: Single hospital: 80 started, 50 completed, 30 missing. Missing reasons: 10 technical problems, 6 reporting burden, 14 unknown. Means for 50 completers, before / eight weeks: symptoms out of 10 6.2 / 4.1; missed-activity days per month 3 / 2; reliever-use days per week 4 / 3. Higher symptom score means more symptoms. No comparison group. Medication changed in 18/50 completers. Developer-funded. Questionnaire validation not described. Full questionnaire, protocol and raw data unpublished. Fictional evaluation.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Checks whether the study design can support the claimed conclusion (e.g. no comparison group and only eight weeks of follow-up)

Middle

- Considers how missing results might affect the finding (e.g. 50 of 80 completed the evaluation)
- Identifies other explanations for improvement (e.g. medication changed for 18 of the completers)
- Checks whether the measurements and reporting are trustworthy (e.g. questionnaire suitability and access to the full results)

End

- Separates an observed improvement from proof that the intervention caused it (e.g. symptoms improved among completers, but the app may not be the reason)

Mistakes to avoid

- Applying the result to everyone or assuming the intervention caused the change (e.g. saying all 80 starters improved)

You are editing the berry article for a health news site. Does its claim about cancer risk follow from the numbers, and how would you rewrite the message?

Image: Berry news and study
Source facts: Fictional news headline: Berry halves cancer risk. Subheading: Fewer diagnoses among berry eaters. Study: 600 adults, 18 months, observational. Berry eaters / others: participants 200 / 400; new diagnoses 12 / 20; mean age 54 / 61; current smokers 20% / 30%; higher-income households 75% / 40%. Diet self-reported once. Complete follow-up with clinical-record diagnoses. No adjustment for age, smoking or income. Fictional article and dataset.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Checks whether the headline matches the actual results (e.g. comparing rates rather than raw diagnosis counts)

Middle

- Uses appropriate percentages to make a fair comparison (e.g. 12/200 = 6% versus 20/400 = 5%)
- Explains why raw counts can mislead when group sizes differ (e.g. fewer cases in the smaller group does not mean lower risk)
- Recognises other differences that might explain the results (e.g. age, smoking, income and diet recorded only once)

End

- Suggests an accurate conclusion that reflects the study’s limits (e.g. no evidence that berries halved risk and no proof of cause and effect)

Mistakes to avoid

- Repeating the headline or claiming benefit or harm without adequate evidence (e.g. judging risk from case numbers alone)

Design a follow-up study of virtual reality for anatomy teaching. Explain how you would make the comparison fair and check whether any learning benefit lasts.

Image: Virtual reality and anatomy learning
Source facts: One medical school, four-week optional pilot. 32 of 160 students volunteered; 4 missed the final quiz. Mean score before 64%, after 72%; same 28 students and same 20 questions. 24/28 rated sessions useful. 6/32 reported dizziness. No comparison group; usual teaching continued. Setup £8,000. Lecturer taught and marked. No later or practical assessment. Fictional education pilot.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses the supplied image accurately and distinguishes observation from interpretation

Start

- Proposes research that addresses the main gaps in the existing evidence (e.g. whether a small voluntary VR pilot produces lasting learning)

Middle

- Suggests a fair comparison with a suitable sample (e.g. students allocated to usual teaching with or without VR)
- Uses measurements that test meaningful and lasting benefit (e.g. independent marking and later practical assessment)
- Considers drawbacks, access and cost as well as effectiveness (e.g. dizziness, dropouts and setup costs)

End

- Defines what evidence would justify using the intervention (e.g. useful learning that lasts without unacceptable burden or harm)

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating a short-term score change as proof of wider benefit (e.g. assuming a rise from 64% to 72% proves better clinical ability)

Rank the five healthcare improvement proposals and choose two to launch next year. Explain your criteria, trade-offs and how the group could reach agreement.

Image: Healthcare improvement proposals
Source facts: Capacity for two programme launches next year. A Surgery: 1,400 waiting over a year; weekend operating lists; launch 3 months; staff cover unconfirmed. B Mental health: median wait 18 weeks; two community teams; launch 9 months; recruitment uncertain. C Maternity: gaps in overnight senior cover; extra cover and training; launch 6 months; harm rates not estimated. D Vaccination: uptake 84% locally and 72% in one area; outreach and translated invitations; launch 2 months; participation uncertain. E Buildings: 120 appointments cancelled last quarter; replace ventilation and electrics; completion 18 months; clinics must relocate. Fictional planning brief.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Agrees clear decision criteria and recognises the practical limit (e.g. capacity for two programme launches)

Middle

- Compares urgency, need and likely benefit (e.g. long surgical waits versus gaps in maternity cover)
- Considers feasibility, access and missing evidence (e.g. staffing, costs and an 18-month building project)
- Invites different views and weighs alternatives (e.g. vaccination gaps versus mental-health recruitment needs)

End

- Justifies a feasible choice and explains how agreement could be reached (e.g. two launch priorities, without inventing other group members' contributions)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ranking by one number or insisting on one correct choice (e.g. choosing only the service with the largest waiting list)

Choose a package of whole NHS projects costing no more than £10 million. Explain your trade-offs and what further evidence you would request.

Image: NHS improvement budget
Source facts: Total budget £10m, whole-project funding only. Community mental-health team £4m: earlier local support, specialist recruitment needed. Two operating theatres £6m: more surgical capacity, additional staff needed. Diabetes prevention £3m: reduce future illness, benefits take time. Digital-record upgrade £5m: information shared across services, training and transition needed. Rural mobile clinic £2m: reaches isolated communities, limited weekly visits. Fictional one-year project costs.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Recognises the budget and funding rules (e.g. £10m and whole-project funding only)

Middle

- Checks the total cost of a feasible combination (e.g. £4m mental health plus £6m theatres)
- Explains the benefits and trade-offs of included and omitted options (e.g. prevention benefits may take longer)
- Considers delivery and fair access while hearing other views (e.g. staff recruitment or rural access)

End

- Justifies an affordable package and identifies evidence that could change it (e.g. alternative combinations are valid with sound reasoning)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring budget rules or equating activity with benefit (e.g. part-funding a project that requires whole-project funding)

Choose five items for the group to take overnight on the mountain. Explain your assumptions, trade-offs and how you would reach agreement.

Image: Overnight on the mountain
Source facts: Four adults, rain, 3°C overnight, dusk in 30 minutes. Carrying capacity five items. Available: waterproof sheet, first-aid kit, map, compass, dry matches, water (two litres total), rope (10 metres), torch, chocolate bars, phone (20% battery). Phone signal is intermittent. Fictional survival exercise.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Identifies immediate needs and practical limits (e.g. cold, rain, approaching dusk and five-item carrying capacity)

Middle

- Prioritises safety, shelter and access to help (e.g. a waterproof sheet or a way to contact rescuers)
- Uses the supplied details when judging usefulness (e.g. intermittent phone signal and limited battery)
- Explains trade-offs while considering the group’s needs and skills (e.g. water versus navigation equipment)

End

- Agrees a feasible selection and plan with clear assumptions (e.g. five items, allowing other defensible choices)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring a limit or assuming equipment guarantees safety (e.g. choosing more than five items or relying on matches alone)

Plan a public-health campaign with a team.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Agrees a defined public-health aim and audience with the team

Middle

- Allocates tasks using team strengths and community input
- Plans accessible evidence-informed messages and delivery

End

- Sets a feasible timeline and measure of impact

Mistakes to avoid

- Designing a campaign without identifying the audience or evaluating behaviour

Work with a group to propose a practical way of reducing missed hospital appointments.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Explores why appointments are missed before choosing a solution

Middle

- Considers reminders, transport, booking flexibility and language barriers
- Invites group ideas and checks privacy and digital exclusion

End

- Proposes a focused pilot with attendance and equity measures

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming missed appointments always reflect carelessness

Develop a brief plan to improve student wellbeing.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Defines a student-wellbeing need with student input

Middle

- Combines practical support with changes to workload or culture
- Agrees realistic roles and accessible delivery

End

- Sets a review measure beyond attendance at wellbeing events

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering a generic activity without addressing the identified problem

Help a group choose practical steps to reduce a hospital's environmental impact.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Agrees an environmental aim consistent with safe care

Middle

- Compares energy, transport or procurement changes with the group
- Checks infection control, costs and staff feasibility

End

- Chooses practical actions and measures impact

Mistakes to avoid

- Prioritising waste reduction over patient safety without appraisal

Put the four patient presentations in a provisional order for assessment. Explain who you would alert and what further information you need.

Image: Four patient presentations
Source facts: You are a student on placement; a clinician is nearby. A, age 67: new chest pressure and sweating, started 20 minutes ago. B, age 24: ankle pain after a fall, able to walk, injury one hour ago. C, age 45: prescription query, no current symptoms, routine medicine running low. D, age 5: fever, unusually difficult to wake, parent says this is not normal. Fictional cases.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Recognises signs of potentially serious illness that need prompt help (e.g. unusual difficulty waking or new chest pressure)

Middle

- Gets appropriate help for urgent concerns without unnecessary delay (e.g. alerting the nearby clinician about both urgent presentations)
- Explains why other requests can provisionally wait (e.g. an ankle injury in someone able to walk)
- Seeks information that could change urgency without diagnosing independently (e.g. breathing, responsiveness or deterioration)

End

- Explains the provisional order, communication and reassessment (e.g. revising priorities if symptoms change)

Mistakes to avoid

- Prioritising on irrelevant characteristics or working beyond the student role (e.g. using age alone or making an independent diagnosis)

Propose a focused change that could ease pressure on an emergency department, and discuss it with your group.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Identifies one emergency-department pressure to address

Middle

- Explains a focused change and how it would affect flow
- Invites team challenge about staffing, access and displacement of demand

End

- Proposes a pilot measuring safety and overall waiting

Mistakes to avoid

- Redirecting patients without ensuring suitable alternative care

Plan a short health-education programme for teenagers with your group.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Explains collaboration and inclusion without inventing contributions by other group members

Start

- Agrees a specific teenage audience and learning goal

Middle

- Uses age-appropriate interactive content and young people's input
- Assigns roles and considers confidentiality and safeguarding

End

- Checks understanding and usefulness after delivery

Mistakes to avoid

- Lecturing teenagers without exploring their needs or concerns

Put the five people in a provisional order for attention. Explain your immediate safety actions, who you would alert and how you would communicate delays.

Image: Assessment queue
Source facts: Five people need attention; clinical help is available. A: sudden facial droop and slurred speech, last well 15 minutes ago. B: mild rash for three weeks, no breathing difficulty. C: worsening breathlessness and blue lips, deteriorating over five minutes. D: routine medication refill, supply lasts three more days. E: deep cut, bleeding controlled by pressure. Fictional Med interview scenario.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Recognises immediate clinical danger (e.g. rapidly worsening breathing or sudden facial droop and slurred speech)

Middle

- Gets help for simultaneous urgent concerns rather than relying on a rigid queue (e.g. breathing difficulty and possible stroke symptoms)
- Justifies relative urgency using the available facts (e.g. a routine refill can wait while acute deterioration is assessed)
- Communicates key information within the student's role (e.g. when symptoms started or when the person was last well)

End

- Reviews priorities and explains delays without false reassurance (e.g. checking whether a waiting person is deteriorating)

Mistakes to avoid

- Delaying urgent help or claiming certainty beyond the evidence (e.g. putting a refill before acute deterioration)

Choose three demands to address immediately. Explain what you would do about the other two and who you would involve.

Image: Five competing demands
Source facts: You are a student on placement. A: a fire alarm is sounding on your floor. B: a distressed friend has asked you to call. C: coursework is due in two hours. D: a patient's identification label may be wrong. E: you need food before the shop closes tonight. Fictional task sheet.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Identifies immediate safety concerns before less urgent commitments (e.g. a fire alarm or possible wrong-patient label)

Middle

- Takes appropriate safety action and seeks help (e.g. following the local fire response and alerting a supervisor)
- Clarifies uncertainty that could change priorities (e.g. whether the distressed friend is at immediate risk)
- Explains how delayed tasks will be managed (e.g. communicating, delegating or rearranging coursework)

End

- Justifies immediate priorities and adapts the plan if new risks emerge (e.g. three actions with a contingency for the friend’s safety)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring clear risk or making unsupported assumptions (e.g. treating the friend’s distress as definitely harmless or definitely an emergency)

Prioritise the five requests in the team inbox. Explain what you would do first, what could be delegated and who needs an update.

Image: Team inbox
Source facts: You are a student on placement. Requests arriving at 10:00. Nurse: a patient has become suddenly confused. Receptionist: a family wants an update. Pharmacist: a routine prescription needs clarification by the prescriber before 14:00. Student colleague: help requested with tomorrow's teaching. Manager: the monthly survey is due today. Fictional team messages.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Recognises which request may involve immediate harm (e.g. a newly confused patient)

Middle

- Escalates urgent concerns and respects time-sensitive deadlines (e.g. clinical help now and prescription clarification before 14:00)
- Communicates appropriately while respecting privacy (e.g. checking permission before a family update)
- Delegates and gives realistic timings for less urgent work (e.g. tomorrow’s teaching or the survey)

End

- Checks tasks are completed and revises the order when facts change (e.g. new clinical deterioration)

Mistakes to avoid

- Prioritising by seniority alone or acting beyond the student role (e.g. changing a prescription personally)

Choose a package of whole proposals within the £5 million budget. Explain your trade-offs and what further evidence you would need.

Image: Health-service funding proposals
Source facts: £5m available for year one, whole-proposal funding only. Mental-health crisis line: £2m, estimated 4,000 users, repeat calls may affect capacity. New cancer scanner: £4m, 1,100 scans, staffing may delay full use. Community falls prevention: £1m, 3,000 older adults, attendance uncertain. Extra neonatal beds: £3m, 240 admissions, length of stay varies. These figures describe different activities, not equivalent health benefits. Fictional year-one estimates.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Identifies the budget and funding constraints (e.g. £5m for year one and whole proposals only)

Middle

- Checks that the proposed combination is affordable (e.g. £2m crisis line plus £3m neonatal beds)
- Recognises when activity figures are different measures and cannot be compared directly (e.g. users, scans and admissions)
- Weighs need, likely benefit and delivery uncertainty (e.g. staffing or length of stay)

End

- Justifies a feasible choice and asks for more comparable evidence (e.g. health outcomes rather than a single activity ranking)

Mistakes to avoid

- Exceeding the budget or treating different activities as equivalent benefit (e.g. adding scans and admissions as lives helped)

Rank the four public-health options by likely impact. Explain your criteria and why reach alone does not show health benefit.

Image: Public-health investment estimates
Source facts: School vaccination outreach: year-one reach 1,200 children, cost £120,000, benefit horizon 3–12 months, parental consent uncertain. Smoking-cessation support: 800 adults, £80,000, 1–5 years, programme uptake uncertain. Air-quality monitoring: area covers 20,000 residents, £60,000, benefit depends on policy action, uncertainty about action on findings. Free community exercise: 1,500 adults, £45,000, 6–12 months, continued attendance uncertain. All costs are year one. Fictional estimates.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Agrees what impact means before ranking options (e.g. benefit, numbers reached, fair access and time to benefit)

Middle

- Compares costs and potential reach without treating them as the whole answer (e.g. vaccination costs £120,000 for 1,200 children)
- Distinguishes direct support from activity that needs further action (e.g. air monitoring only improves health if findings lead to change)
- Considers how reliable and achievable the estimates are (e.g. uncertain uptake or continued attendance)

End

- Gives a reasoned ranking while identifying evidence that could change it (e.g. measured health gains)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ranking by the largest number or assuming reach guarantees benefit (e.g. choosing monitoring only because it covers 20,000 residents)

When faced with an unfamiliar situation, how would you identify the information you need most urgently?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Checks for immediate danger before gathering detail

Middle

- Identifies information that would change urgency or action
- Uses reliable sources and appropriate help without delaying essential safety steps

End

- Reassesses once key uncertainties are resolved

Mistakes to avoid

- Collecting every possible detail before responding to clear risk

Using the diary, explain what you would keep, rearrange or delegate, and how you would communicate the changes.

Image: A difficult Thursday
Source facts: Thursday: 09:00 compulsory seminar; 12:00 volunteering shift, cover may be available; 15:00 group-project meeting; 17:00 medical appointment booked two months ago; 18:00 family celebration. Friday 09:00 coursework due; three hours of coursework still to do. Fictional planning exercise.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Identifies fixed commitments, deadlines and the work remaining (e.g. Friday 09:00 coursework due and three hours still needed)

Middle

- Protects important commitments and considers consequences of delay (e.g. a compulsory seminar or long-booked healthcare appointment)
- Checks what can realistically be rearranged (e.g. volunteering cover or meeting flexibility)
- Allows time for work, travel and rest while communicating changes (e.g. informing family or colleagues)

End

- Gives a workable plan and an alternative if assumptions fail (e.g. if volunteering cover is unavailable)

Mistakes to avoid

- Ignoring commitments or assuming flexibility without checking (e.g. silently missing a shift or sacrificing necessary healthcare)

Which patient-safety concern would you escalate first? Explain your immediate actions, who you would involve and what should be recorded.

Image: Four patient-safety concerns
Source facts: You are a student on placement; senior help available. A: medicine administered despite a documented allergy to it; patient currently feels well. B: vaccine fridge 1°C above its displayed permitted range, vaccines inside, duration unknown. C: medicine nearly given to the wrong patient, caught before administration. D: small corridor spill with missing wet-floor sign; corridor currently empty. Fictional incidents.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Recognises actual harm and potential risks that need prompt attention (e.g. medicine given despite a documented allergy)

Middle

- Seeks appropriate assessment and reports the facts within the student role (e.g. alerting clinical staff even if the patient currently feels well)
- Prevents further risk while seeking authorised advice (e.g. an out-of-range vaccine fridge)
- Ensures remaining concerns are addressed through help or delegation (e.g. a near miss or corridor spill)

End

- Follows through on all concerns and reassesses changing risk (e.g. checking that responsible staff have acted)

Mistakes to avoid

- Waiting for harm before reporting or taking unauthorised action (e.g. waiting for allergy symptoms or discarding vaccines independently)

What would you do first in this hospital-corridor emergency? Explain who you would call and how you would protect people while staying within the student role.

Image: Several events happen at once
Source facts: Hospital corridor; you are a student on placement. A: smoke visible at a closed store-room door. B: a visitor has collapsed nearby. C: another visitor is filming. D: a colleague asks you to fetch confidential notes. E: the fire alarm has not sounded. Fictional Med interview scenario.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Makes priorities explicit, works within their role and revises decisions when facts change

Start

- Recognises simultaneous immediate dangers (e.g. smoke and a collapsed visitor)

Middle

- Raises the alarm and requests appropriate emergency help (e.g. without opening a smoke-filled store-room)
- Keeps self and others safe while helping within training (e.g. assisting the collapsed visitor only where safe)
- Delegates other tasks and protects privacy without delaying urgent help (e.g. filming or confidential notes)

End

- Follows the local emergency response and reassesses as help arrives (e.g. updating responders about both dangers)

Mistakes to avoid

- Entering danger or prioritising a less urgent request (e.g. entering smoke or fetching notes before calling for help)

Explain clearly how you would reassess your priorities if new information became available.

General

- Uses structured reasoning
- Shows flexibility rather than rigidity
- Prioritises safety
- Communicates changes clearly

Start

- Acknowledges the new information
- Checks that it is relevant and reliable
- Reassesses before continuing with the original plan

Middle

- Reconsiders urgency and risk
- Considers the consequences of delaying each task
- Changes priorities where justified
- Seeks help or delegates where appropriate

End

- Clearly states the revised priority
- Explains why the priority changed
- Continues reassessing if more information becomes available

Mistakes to avoid

- Sticking rigidly to the original plan
- Acting without considering the new information
- Ignoring safety
- Failing to communicate a change in priorities

Looking two centuries ahead, which responsibilities of doctors might have disappeared, and what might have taken their place?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Offers a plausible future change while acknowledging speculation

Middle

- Explains why a current responsibility might diminish
- Describes a replacement responsibility and its implications for patients

End

- Recognises uncertainty over two centuries

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting a technological prediction as inevitable

Design a memorable event about medicine. What would people take part in, and what would you want them to take away?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines an audience and memorable purpose for the event

Middle

- Describes an engaging activity people would actually join
- Considers accessibility, feasibility and accurate content

End

- States what participants should take away

Mistakes to avoid

- Proposing spectacle with no clear medical learning or purpose

Think of uses for a phone charger that have nothing to do with charging a phone.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies the charger's physical features for creative reuse

Middle

- Suggests distinct non-charging uses with a practical explanation
- Considers feasibility and avoids dangerous live-electrical use

End

- Selects a useful or imaginative idea and explains why

Mistakes to avoid

- Suggesting unsafe electrical modifications or merely charging another phone

You have six months free from study, with your living costs covered. Describe a creative project or experience unrelated to medicine that you would pursue.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- Chooses an authentic non-medical creative project

Middle

- Explains how six months would be used
- Considers skills, resources and challenges despite living costs being covered

End

- Describes a meaningful outcome or learning goal

Mistakes to avoid

- Turning the answer into another medical placement or ignoring the time limit

Food, drinking water and shelter are available on an isolated island where you must stay. You can bring three more items. What would you choose, and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises food, drinking water and shelter are already provided

Middle

- Chooses exactly three additional items
- Explains communication, wellbeing or practical value with stated assumptions

End

- Shows how the items work together for the stay

Mistakes to avoid

- Spending all choices solving needs already covered without justification

How would you assess whether the money spent taking people to the Moon was justified?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Defines criteria for judging the Moon programme's cost

Middle

- Weighs scientific, technological or social gains against opportunity cost
- Considers uncertainty and who benefited

End

- Gives a reasoned balanced judgement

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming exploration is automatically priceless or useless

If you could solve one global problem overnight, which would you choose and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses one clearly defined global problem

Middle

- Explains its scale and effect on people
- Considers knock-on benefits and remaining challenges

End

- Justifies the priority without claiming it solves everything

Mistakes to avoid

- Naming several problems without selecting one

If you could have dinner with one historical figure, who would it be and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Names a historical figure and an authentic reason

Middle

- Explains what they would ask and hope to understand
- Engages critically with the figure's context or limitations

End

- Connects the choice with their own curiosity

Mistakes to avoid

- Providing a biography instead of explaining the conversation

Briefly teach me something interesting in sixty seconds.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Introduces one teachable idea suited to sixty seconds

Middle

- Explains it accurately with a concise example
- Adapts language to the listener and keeps focus

End

- Ends with a clear takeaway or quick understanding check

Mistakes to avoid

- Trying to cover an entire subject in one minute

Suggest five inventive uses for a paperclip beyond holding papers together.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Provides five distinct non-paper-holding uses

Middle

- Explains plausible adaptations of the paperclip's shape
- Shows creativity while considering safety

End

- Keeps the answer concise and varied

Mistakes to avoid

- Repeating the same use in different words or proposing unsafe use in electrical sockets

You can choose one modern technology for society to stop using. Which would you pick, and what might the consequences be?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Chooses one modern technology and a clear concern

Middle

- Weighs benefits lost against harms avoided
- Considers substitutes and unintended effects on different groups

End

- Justifies the choice while acknowledging trade-offs

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming removing a technology has only positive consequences

Your community receives a fund of ten million pounds. What would you spend it on, and how would you justify those priorities?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies local needs before allocating £10m

Middle

- Proposes feasible priorities and recognises ongoing costs
- Includes community input and benefits for underserved groups

End

- Explains a transparent budget and way to evaluate results

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising more projects than the fund can support

Describe an opinion you once held strongly but later changed.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Uses Situation, Task, Action, Result and Reflection naturally where an experience is requested, with emphasis on learning

Start

- States the former strong opinion and why it was held

Middle

- Explains the evidence or perspective that challenged it
- Shows an actual change rather than a cosmetic qualification

End

- Reflects on how they now evaluate beliefs

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming open-mindedness while never describing what changed

Which invention do you think has changed humanity most significantly?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Selects one invention and defines significant impact

Middle

- Explains effects on human life with concrete examples
- Compares its reach or consequences with another plausible choice

End

- Justifies a subjective ranking thoughtfully

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming there is one undisputed correct invention

If you could redesign one part of healthcare from scratch, what would you change?

General

- Chooses one clear and specific idea
- Uses logical problem-solving
- Considers different perspectives
- Recognises possible limitations

Start

- Identifies one healthcare problem
- Clearly explains the proposed change

Middle

- Explains how the change could improve healthcare
- Considers the effect on patients and healthcare staff
- Considers practical difficulties or costs
- Recognises possible disadvantages or unintended effects

End

- Summarises the intended improvement
- Explains how success could be assessed
- Recognises the proposal may need to be adjusted

Mistakes to avoid

- Trying to redesign the whole healthcare system
- Giving an idea without explaining the reasoning
- Ignoring disadvantages or practical problems
- Claiming the idea would definitely work

Briefly describe yourself in three words.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Gives three distinct words promptly

Middle

- Adds brief evidence rather than a long story
- Keeps the description credible and personal

End

- Finishes within the quick-fire scope

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving a list of unsupported superlatives or more than three words

What most motivates you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names their main source of motivation directly

Middle

- Explains why it matters personally
- Gives a short example of it driving action

End

- Returns to the motivating value

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering only a vague wish to succeed

How would you describe your greatest strength?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Selects one greatest strength

Middle

- Supports it with one concise example
- Explains its useful effect

End

- Shows realistic self-awareness

Mistakes to avoid

- Listing many strengths instead of choosing one

What would you say you are currently working to improve?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names a genuine current development area

Middle

- States one action they are taking
- Explains how they will notice progress

End

- Shows improvement is ongoing

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering a disguised boast without a development action

Which achievement means the most to you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names the achievement with the greatest personal meaning

Middle

- Explains effort or significance briefly
- Acknowledges others' help where relevant

End

- States what it taught them

Mistakes to avoid

- Relying solely on the achievement's prestige

Who most inspires you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names a person who inspires them

Middle

- Identifies a specific quality or action
- Explains its personal influence

End

- Connects inspiration with something they try to do

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving a celebrity biography without personal relevance

What do you value most highly in a friend?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Chooses one valued quality in friendship

Middle

- Explains why it matters in a relationship
- Offers a brief example of that quality

End

- Recognises friendship involves reciprocity

Mistakes to avoid

- Describing only what others should provide for them

What tends to make you a good teammate?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Identifies one useful teamwork behaviour

Middle

- Supports it with a compact example
- Recognises the contribution of others

End

- Links it to a shared outcome

Mistakes to avoid

- Calling themselves the best member without evidence

What tends to make you a good leader?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Identifies a leadership behaviour that helps others

Middle

- Uses a short example of direction, inclusion or delegation
- Shows accountability rather than status

End

- Connects leadership with the team's goal

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating leadership with control or speaking most

How would you react to failure?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Acknowledges disappointment after failure

Middle

- Describes reflection and seeking useful feedback
- Identifies a practical adjustment

End

- Shows willingness to try again or reassess sensibly

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming failure never affects them

How would you respond to criticism?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Listens before reacting to criticism

Middle

- Clarifies what needs improvement
- Uses useful feedback without accepting unsupported claims blindly

End

- States a next step or review

Mistakes to avoid

- Responding defensively before understanding the concern

What tends to make you stressed?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names a specific stress trigger

Middle

- Explains how it affects them briefly
- Describes a realistic way to manage it

End

- Recognises when additional help may be needed

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming to be immune to stress

What usually helps you recover after a difficult day?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names a healthy way they recover after difficulty

Middle

- Explains why it helps them
- Recognises the value of rest or supportive contact

End

- Distinguishes ordinary recovery from ongoing difficulties needing help

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting avoidance or relentless work as the only coping method

What tends to make you curious?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Identifies a genuine source of curiosity

Middle

- Gives a brief example of a question they pursued
- Explains how they investigated it

End

- Shows enjoyment of learning rather than collecting facts

Mistakes to avoid

- Saying everything interests them without an example

What do you most enjoy learning about outside medicine?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names a non-medical subject they enjoy

Middle

- Explains what draws them to it
- Mentions a specific thing recently learned

End

- Keeps the answer authentic and focused

Mistakes to avoid

- Forcing the interest back into medicine when asked about something outside it

What is one thing people often misunderstand about you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Identifies a plausible misunderstanding about themselves

Middle

- Explains the difference between appearance and intention
- Shows how they help others understand them

End

- Remains fair to those who misread them

Mistakes to avoid

- Blaming everyone else or presenting criticism as proof of superiority

What do you think your friends would say is your most noticeable characteristic?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Chooses a noticeable characteristic friends might recognise

Middle

- Supports it with a shared interaction or feedback
- Keeps the description balanced

End

- Relates their self-view to others' experience

Mistakes to avoid

- Inventing universal admiration

Can you describe when you have shown courage?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Briefly describes a situation involving fear or difficulty

Middle

- Explains the action taken despite discomfort
- Distinguishes courage from unnecessary risk

End

- Reflects on what the action taught them

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating recklessness with bravery

Can you describe when you have shown kindness?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Gives a specific act responding to another person's need

Middle

- Explains how they recognised what would help
- Respects the person's dignity and preferences

End

- Reflects modestly on its effect

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating kindness as a story about their own exceptional virtue

Can you describe when you have demonstrated integrity?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Describes a situation testing honesty or principles

Middle

- Explains their decision despite inconvenience or pressure
- Acknowledges consequences and responsibility

End

- Connects the example with consistent conduct

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering a claim of integrity without a real choice or action

How would you test whether your interest in medicine remains realistic when the work feels routine rather than exciting?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges that medicine includes routine and repetitive work

Middle

- Explains how observing everyday responsibilities could test their expectations
- Identifies which values would sustain effort without constant novelty

End

- Names a practical way to explore less visible aspects of the role

Mistakes to avoid

- Equating enjoyment of dramatic cases with commitment to daily patient care

What would you want to learn about a doctor's working day before deciding that medicine is the right career for you?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies a specific uncertainty about the working day

Middle

- Considers time spent documenting, coordinating and following up care
- Explains how a conversation or observation could address that uncertainty

End

- Connects the finding with an informed personal career decision

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming all specialties or working environments have the same daily routine

A teammate says they understand your explanation, but their next action suggests otherwise. How would you check understanding without embarrassing them?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises that apparent agreement may not mean shared understanding

Middle

- Invites the teammate to describe the next step in their own words
- Rephrases the explanation privately and takes responsibility for clarity

End

- Checks the agreed action with a supportive tone

Mistakes to avoid

- Testing or correcting the teammate publicly in a humiliating way

How would you repair a conversation after realising that you interrupted someone who was trying to explain a concern?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Acknowledges the interruption without making excuses

Middle

- Apologises briefly and invites the person to finish
- Listens to and summarises the concern before responding

End

- Checks whether anything important remains unheard

Mistakes to avoid

- Offering an apology and immediately continuing to dominate the conversation

How would you approach a situation where following a rule appears to disadvantage one person unfairly?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Separates the purpose of the rule from its effect in this case

Middle

- Clarifies the facts and perspectives before judging unfairness
- Considers proportionate alternatives and seeks authorised advice

End

- Explains a fair and accountable decision without bypassing safeguards

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming that either rigid obedience or secretly ignoring the rule is always ethical

Why might a decision that has a good outcome still raise concerns about professionalism?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes an outcome from the way a decision was made

Middle

- Considers honesty, consent, respect or working within competence
- Explains why a fortunate result does not remove avoidable risks

End

- Links responsible processes with trust and learning from decisions

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating success as proof that every action taken was acceptable

Why does coordinating care between different professionals matter as much as making an individual clinical decision?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Recognises that care depends on coordinated contributions

Middle

- Explains how clear responsibilities and information transfer support continuity
- Identifies how fragmented plans can create delays or misunderstandings

End

- Links coordination with a shared plan centred on the patient

Mistakes to avoid

- Presenting a doctor as the only professional responsible for effective care

How could a doctor help a patient understand what will happen after they leave a consultation?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies the need for a clear plan after the appointment

Middle

- Explains next steps and whom to contact in accessible language
- Checks understanding and considers practical barriers to following the plan

End

- Summarises a realistic follow-up arrangement without promising outcomes

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming that giving written instructions guarantees understanding or access

A hospital is considering an app that reminds patients about appointments. What questions should it ask before introducing it?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Clarifies the intended benefit of appointment reminders

Middle

- Considers access, privacy and alternatives for people who cannot use an app
- Asks how success and unintended effects will be measured

End

- Proposes a limited evaluation with patient feedback before wider adoption

Mistakes to avoid

- Assuming that smartphone access or reduced missed appointments is guaranteed

How should a healthcare organisation respond when an online health claim becomes popular before its evidence has been checked?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Separates popularity from reliability of the claim

Middle

- Explains how to review sources and communicate uncertainty promptly
- Considers an accessible response that avoids amplifying misleading details

End

- States how advice should be updated as evidence improves

Mistakes to avoid

- Repeating an unverified claim confidently or dismissing concerned people without explanation

In a fictional study, 30% of participants leave one group but only 5% leave the other. Why should this make you cautious about comparing the final results?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Identifies unequal loss to follow-up

Middle

- Explains that remaining participants may differ systematically from those who left
- Asks why people left and how missing outcomes were handled

End

- Gives a cautious interpretation rather than assuming the comparison is unbiased

Mistakes to avoid

- Treating unequal dropout as proof of an effect or ignoring the missing participants

A fictional service survey receives replies from 80 out of 1,000 invited users, and most replies are positive. What can and cannot be concluded?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question

Start

- Distinguishes the respondents from the full invited group

Middle

- Notes the low response rate and possible non-response bias
- Recognises that positive replies describe those who responded rather than every user

End

- Suggests ways to understand non-respondents before generalising

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming the survey proves that most of all 1,000 users are satisfied

Role play: a classmate says they feel left out of a revision group. Start a conversation to understand what has happened and agree a next step.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Opens with a welcoming acknowledgement of the concern

Middle

- Uses an open question and allows the classmate to describe their experience
- Reflects what they say without assuming the intentions of other students

End

- Agrees a manageable next step with their input

Mistakes to avoid

- Promising to confront the whole group before hearing the classmate's account

Role play: you agreed to help organise an event but now cannot meet the deadline. Explain this to the organiser and discuss a practical way forward.

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Demonstrates the requested communication, using natural language and space for the other person to respond

Start

- Raises the difficulty promptly and accepts responsibility for the commitment

Middle

- Explains the relevant limitation without excessive excuses
- Offers realistic alternatives and asks about the most urgent needs

End

- Confirms an achievable revised plan and how updates will be shared

Mistakes to avoid

- Concealing the delay or offering another deadline they cannot meet

What is one small habit that has made you more dependable?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Names a specific everyday habit

Middle

- Gives a brief example of using the habit consistently
- Explains how it helps others rely on their contribution

End

- Keeps the response concise and proportionate

Mistakes to avoid

- Claiming dependability without describing observable behaviour

If you had to explain your approach to learning in one sentence, what would you say and why?

General

- Answers the specific task with clear, relevant reasoning
- Supports claims with examples or evidence appropriate to this question
- Keeps the answer concise and personal; a long structured story is not required

Start

- Offers a clear one-sentence description of their learning approach

Middle

- Explains one reason behind the approach
- Uses a short example or acknowledges when it needs adapting

End

- Stops after a focused explanation rather than listing every study method

Mistakes to avoid

- Using a slogan that does not describe how they actually learn